“The past is gone:

Learn from it.

The future is ahead:

Prepare for it.

The present is here:

Live it!”

Thomas S. Monson

1

NEGOTIATION

IT'S YOUR TURN

IDIOMS

- BLACK AND WHITE
- NO IFS, ANDS, OR BUTS
- RULE OUT
- HAVE IT BOTH WAYS
- UP IN THE AIR
- PROS AND CONS
- FINE LINE
- NOT SEE THE FOREST FOR THE TREES
- SEE SOMETHING IN A WHOLE NEW LIGHT
- RIGHT UNDER ONE'S NOSE
- CHANGE ONE'S TUNE
- MAKE A PLUG

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

BLACK AND WHITE

To have two sides that are extremes: right and wrong, or good and bad, with nothing in between. Things can only be *black and white* if they have two sides to them; thus, concrete nouns (a house, a person, or a river) are not usually described as black and white, but issues, opinions, or ideas often are. This phrase is used as an adjective.

Example: In my mind, the issue of abortion is black and white.

NO IFS, ANDS, OR BUTS

Absolutely no excuses; without any doubt; dissension or variance. This phrase is often followed by *about it.*

Example: I have to be in class at seven o'clock tomorrow, no ifs, ands, or buts about it.

RULE OUT

Eliminate something. The object can be placed either after *rule* or after *out;* however, if the object is a pronoun, it must go after *rule*.

Examples: That movie was nominated for an Academy Award. However, the Director's Guild didn't like it, and so they ruled <u>it</u> out. **(NOT** They ruled out it.) **OR** The Director's Guild ruled out that movie for an Academy Award.

This idiom is also commonly used in the passive voice.

Example: Any chances for that movie to win the Academy Award have been ruled out.

HAVE IT BOTH WAYS

To have two things at the same time that are incompatible with each other.

This idiom is usually used in the negative. Do not try to replace it with anything.

Example: I'd love to have the cultural advantages of living in the city without the traffic and congestion, but I know I can't have it both ways.

UP IN THE AIR

Uncertain; unknown; undecided. Concrete nouns are not usually used as the subject of this phrase; issues, ideas, questions, or problems are more likely to be up in the air. You can paraphrase these as things, or it.

Example: After her horrible accident, the doctors don't know if she will live or die. It's still up in the air.

PROS AND CONS

The advantages and disadvantages.

Example: I'm planning to buy a new car. Do you know the pros and cons of this model?

FINE LINE

A very subtle distinction between two different things. This idiom is usually followed by *between __ and __*.

Example: There is a fine line between criticism and advice.

NOT SEE THE FOREST FOR THE TREES

To be overly preoccupied with the details and unable to see a problem as a whole. This idiom is always used in the negative form.

Example: I was so concerned about finding the two dollars I was missing that I didn't notice that the whole house had been robbed. I couldn't see the forest for the trees.

SEE SOMETHING IN A WHOLE NEW LIGHT (or **put something in a new light) To** view or understand something from a different perspective.

Example: You didn't tell me they offered twice as much money to buy the jewelry. That puts their offer in a whole new light!

RIGHT UNDER ONE'S NOSE

In plain view; in a place where something or someone might be easily noticed.

Example: Bobby ate one of the freshly baked cookies right under his mother's nose.

CHANGE ONE'S TUNE

To change how one feels or what one says about a particular issue.

Example*:* She said she hated the book until she found out I was the author. Then she changed her tune.

MAKE A PLUG

To speak out in support of something or someone; to publicize something.

Be sure to say what you are making a plug for.

Example: The owners of The Pasta Pot were at the food fair to make a plug for their new restaurant.

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

Warming Up

Complete the following activity and questions in pairs or small groups. Compare answers and discuss with your classmates.

1. Fill in the grid below by listing five different types of crimes (for example, robbery, selling drugs, running a red light). Decide on a punishment for each crime. Then ask two of your classmates what they think the punishment should be for each of those crimes.

Crime	**Punishment** You	1st Classmate	2nd Classmate

2. Can you think of any act that is against the law in one country but not in another? Do you know of any law in this country that would not apply in your country, or vice versa?

_____

_____

_____

3. Should people who unknowingly commit a crime because they did not understand the law be held responsible for their actions?

_____

_____

_____

4. Can an act be legal but immoral? Can an act be morally right but unlawful? Give examples.

_____

_____

_____

5. Discuss the following situation with your classmates:

Three sailors were adrift on a life raft after their ship had sunk during a storm. After twenty-five days with no food and little water, together they agreed to draw lots to determine which one of the three would be killed and eaten by the other two. Otherwise, they would all die. Although the loser objected strenuously when his lot was drawn, the other two killed and ate him anyway. Later, the two survivors were rescued and taken back to their homeland. Should the two sailors be tried for murder? Why or why not?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. READING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Read the following article about two immigrants to The United States who were accused of a crime. Consider these questions as you read the article. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. What crime were the two men accused of? What had they done to be charged with that crime?

_____

_____

_____

2. What two groups held opposing viewpoints of the case? List the arguments used for and against the two men.

_____

_____

_____

3. Do you agree that the men should have been brought to trial? Why or why not? If you had been on the jury, would you have found the men guilty or innocent?

_____

_____

_____

4. If the men had been convicted, how should they have been punished?

_____

_____

_____

5. What would have happened to the two men if they had committed the same act in your country?

_____

_____

_____

B. IDENTIFYING THE IDIOMS

Next, read the article to which you have just read. Throughout this article you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

__Black and White
__Change one's tune
__Right under someone's nose
__Not see the forest for the trees
__See something in a whole new light
__Rule out
__No ifs, ands, or buts
__Fine Line
__Have it both ways
__Up in the air
__Make a plug
__Pros and cons

THE PROS AND CONS OF THE AMERICAN DREAM

Few cases tried in a court of law are absolutely black and white. Although justice may seem to favor one side in the beginning, ultimately there is often a fine line between right and wrong, innocent and guilty, victim and criminal. Take, for example, the case of two southeast Asian refugees in Los Angeles who were accused of killing their pet dog for food. Were these men guilty of committing a vicious crime against an animal, or were they victims of a foreign culture with which they were not sufficiently familiar?

Most Americans readily eat the meat of various animals - cows, chickens, pigs, even cute little ones like ducks and rabbits - but certainly not of dogs or cats; and because many Americans feel so strongly about their pets, there are

laws protecting the animals from negligence and abuse. Where the two men came from, however, dogs were routinely turned into dinner, and the refugees did not know they would be offending American sensibilities by eating their dog. In fact, they killed the animal right under the nose of their American neighbor, who, to their surprise, immediately called the police. The two men were charged with cruelty to animals.

Animal rights activists, who for years have loudly proclaimed that animals also deserve protection under the law, were outraged over the act. Using the trial to make a plug for their cause, they picketed the court proceedings, demanding that the "evil criminals" pay heavily for what they had done. They even sent death threats to the two men. Their position was clear: The men should be severely punished or expelled from the country, no ifs, ands, or buts about it.

Others, more inclined to measure the weight of the crime against the trauma that the refugees were undergoing tried to focus on some of the cultural issues involved. They pointed out that those who were obsessed with the dog's death could not see the forest for the trees; in their passion for revenge, the dog's defenders could not recognize the broader cultural issues of this case. If Americans were less ethnocentric, it was said, they might see the refugees' "crime" in a whole new light. In fact, they might begin to understand that their American cultural values were not necessarily defined by universal moral truths. And if those self-righteous Americans ever lived in another country and had to abide strictly by that country's cultural standards, they might change their tune completely.

While both sides argued vigorously against each other in the media, the case presented by the lawyers for the prosecution and the defense would ultimately decide the fate of the two men.

The defense attorney first established that because his clients could not have known they were doing anything wrong, any intent to deliberately break the law must be ruled out. But he also argued that the charge of cruelty to animals would only apply if the men had tortured the dog before killing it. After all he said, we kill animals every day to eat them, and no one would suggest that a steak dinner resulted from cruelty to animals!

On the other hand, the prosecutor claimed that immigrants should be held responsible for understanding and obeying the laws of the land in which they live. Otherwise, there could be no uniform standard of justice for the country, and chaos would ensue. Although he acknowledged the cultural differences in their background, he said the men could not have it both ways; if they broke the law, they should be punished regardless of their country of origin.

Were the two refugees innocent or guilty? The outcome of the trial was up in the air while the jury deliberated. They carefully considered the pros and cons of each side and the implications of convicting the bewildered men of their crime or of letting them go. Finally, they rendered the verdict: The two men were found not guilty.

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following statements. Pay attention to how the idiom is used, and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding letters. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line. The first one is done for you.

1 - I've tried to convince John that our financial status is not **black and white** just because we're not rich, it doesn't mean we're poor.
EX: *two sides that are extremes: right or wrong, or good or bad, with nothing in between*.

2 - Make sure he is the right person for you before you marry him; there is a **fine line** between infatuation and true love.

_____

_____

_____

3 - I can't believe she spends most of the day reading magazines **right under her boss's nose**!

_____

_____

_____

4 - The president appeared at a rally in Washington to **make a plug** for his new economic plan.

_____

_____

_____

5 - The final deadline for the project is February 10. You must complete it by then, **no ifs, ands, or buts.**

_____

_____

_____

6 - Mr. Kramer **can't see the forest for the trees.** He is more concerned about his students' handwriting than the content of their papers.

_____

_____

_____

7 - After his girlfriend broke up with him, Danny recognized that he had not been sensitive to her needs. He began to **see** their relationship **in a whole new light.**

_____

_____

_____

8 - You may think it's Brad's fault that he can't find a job, but if you suddenly lost your job, you might **change your tune.**

_____

_____

_____

9 - Unfortunately, I think we must **rule out** a trip to the beach this weekend. The weather forecast is for rain.

_____

_____

_____

10 - You can't **have it both ways.** If you want to get rich, you'll have to go to work; you can't just spend your days at the beach.

_____

_____

_____

11 - The future of the health care center is still **up in the air.** We cannot make any firm plans until funding has been secured.

_____

_____

_____

12 - The death penalty is not legal in every state. The **pros and cons** of capital punishment continue to be argued vigorously in legislatures around the country.

_____

_____

_____

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Read the choices listed below for each statement you hear. Select the sentence that best relates to the original statement, and circle the corresponding letter.

1.
a. She changed her tune in the movie.
b. She wanted to make a plug for the movie.
c. She thought the movie was black and white.
2.
a. You can't have it both ways.
b. You can't see the forest for the trees.
c. You can't rule marriage out.
3.
a. They are protesting that the school's grading policy is too black and white.
b. They are angry that the teachers changed their tune.

c. They understand the pros and cons of the new grading policy.

4.

a. He couldn't see the forest for the trees.

b. He ruled out firing his secretary.

c. He wanted to have it both ways.

5.

a. They saw the painting in a whole new light.

b. It was right under his nose.

c. The painting is still up in the air!

6.

a. Susie's clothes are very fashionable ---No ifs, ands, or buts about it.

b. Fashion has many pros and cons.

c. There is often a fine line between high fashion and bad taste.

7.

a. I guess that rules him out.

b. Maybe he can make a plug for the job.

c. I think George will change his tune.

8.

a. She feels the contract is right under her nose.

b. She wants to discuss the pros and cons of her contract.

c. There are no ifs, ands, or buts about it.

9.

a. I can't see the forest for the trees.

b. It's still up in the air.

c. I see things in a whole new light.

10.

a. Doctors are likely to rule out nationalized health care.

b. Doctors want to have it both ways.

c. Doctors often discuss the pros and cons of nationalized health care.

11.

a. She realized he was right under her nose.

b. I guess she changed her tune.

c. She felt their relationship was up in the air.

12.

a. There's a fine line between winning and losing.

b. There are no ifs, ands, or buts about the game.

c. The game is still up in the air.

E. RETELLING THE STORY - OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the article again. The sentences below refer to statements in that article. On the lines below, restate the sentences, using the appropriate idiom. The first one is done for you.

1. There are many cases that come to trial that are not easily decided; rarely is one side all good or all bad.
Ex: *Not all cases that are tried in a court of law are black and white.*

2. It is sometimes difficult to determine who is truly at fault; there is often a subtle distinction between the innocent and guilty parties in a case.

_____

_____

_____

3. The men killed the dog in plain view of their neighbor, who then notified the authorities.

_____

_____

_____

4. Animal rights activist used the trial to publicize the objectives of their organization.

_____

_____

_____

5. Their critics stated plainly that the men should either be punished or forced to leave the country, with no other options considered.

_____

_____

_____

6. Some of the men's sympathizers accused the activists of being so consumed with the details of the dog's death that they were unable to recognize the larger issues.

_____

_____

_____

7. They said that if some Americans were not so convinced of their moral superiority, they might view the case from a totally different perspective.

_____

_____

_____

8. They even suggested that the experience of living in a foreign country would cause many Americans to have a completely different opinion of the case.

_____

_____

_____

9. The defense lawyer claimed that because the two men hadn't known that killing their dog was wrong, the possibility that they broke the law on purpose must be eliminated.

_____

_____

_____

10. The prosecutor said that the men could not benefit from living in The United States without also accepting responsibility for obeying its laws.

_____

_____

_____

11. The verdict in the trial was uncertain while the jury discussed the case.

_____

_____

_____

12. The members of the jury argued about the advantages and disadvantages of each side of the case.

_____

_____

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

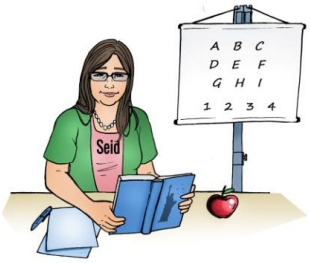
Francine Lewis and Scott Darby are running for mayor in the upcoming election. Their positions on three key issues are summarized below.

Part I

Francine Lewis
Transportation: Although the budget is very limited, she supports investment in both railways and highways.
Education: She wants a special panel of experts to discuss the advantages and disadvantages of private management of the school system before she decides on her position.
Health care: Since Ms. Lewis used to be a nurse; she often uses her speaking opportunities to publicize the need for more and better-trained nurses.

Scott Darby
Transportation: Because of limited funds, he believes that all the money should go to highway construction, and that railways should be eliminated.
Education: He says the government can do the best job of managing schools for less money, and he refuses to discuss it further.
Health Care: He once said that all medical fees and expenses should be set by a government agency, but when a group of doctors contributed generously to his campaign fund, he changed his position on the matter.

As the candidates campaign against other, they try to discredit their opponent. Using the idioms listed below, write how Ms. Lewis would characterize Mr. Darby's positions on each of the issues, and vice versa. Use each idiom only once. Both of their speeches have been started for you.



Pros and cons
No ifs, ands, or buts
Rule out
Make a plug
Change one's tune
Have it both ways

Francine Lewis: "Scott Darby would ruin this beautiful city! Just look at what he plans to do to transportation! Of course, highway construction is important, but he would rule out any spending on railways!

_____

_____

_____

_____

Scott Darby: "Francine Lewis must think that the government has an unlimited source of money. We simply cannot afford to build highways and railways, but she wants to…

_____

_____

_____

Part II

Brett Martin recently opened a convenience store and hired Lisa Henderson to work as a part-time clerk. He had known Lisa for many years and believed that she would be an honest and hardworking employee. However, a few weeks after she started working, a customer saw her take twenty dollars from the cash register and put it in her pocket. The customer told Mr. Martin, and he immediately called Lisa into his office. Complete the conversation between Lisa and her boss. Fill in the blanks with the idioms listed below.

Up in the air
Black and white
Fine line
Can't see the forest for the trees
See things in a whole new light
Right under the nose

Brett: Honesty is a_____ issue. You cannot be halfway honest. You stole twenty dollars from me _____ of a customer! How could you do that?

Lisa: I wasn't stealing. I just needed to borrow some money to buy lunch. I was planning on paying it back!

Brett: There's a _____ between borrowing and stealing. I thought I could trust you, but I'm starting to _____.

Lisa: Brett, maybe you're so worried about this one incident that you _____. You know I've been an excellent employee - I'm always on time, courteous, efficient, and hard working. Why, just last week you promised me a raise!

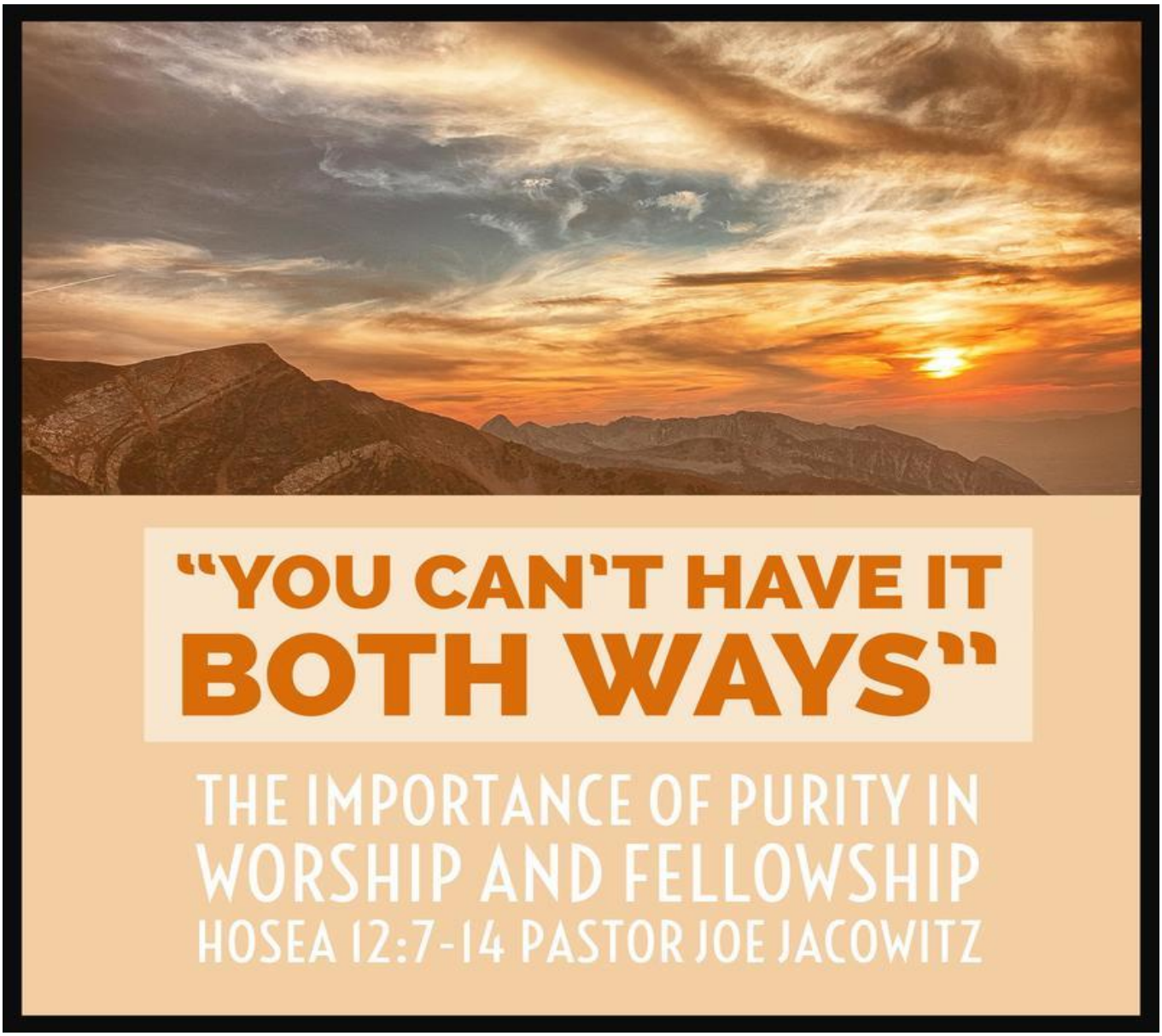
Brett: Well, right now that raise is _____. I'll have to think about it. But first, give me back the money.

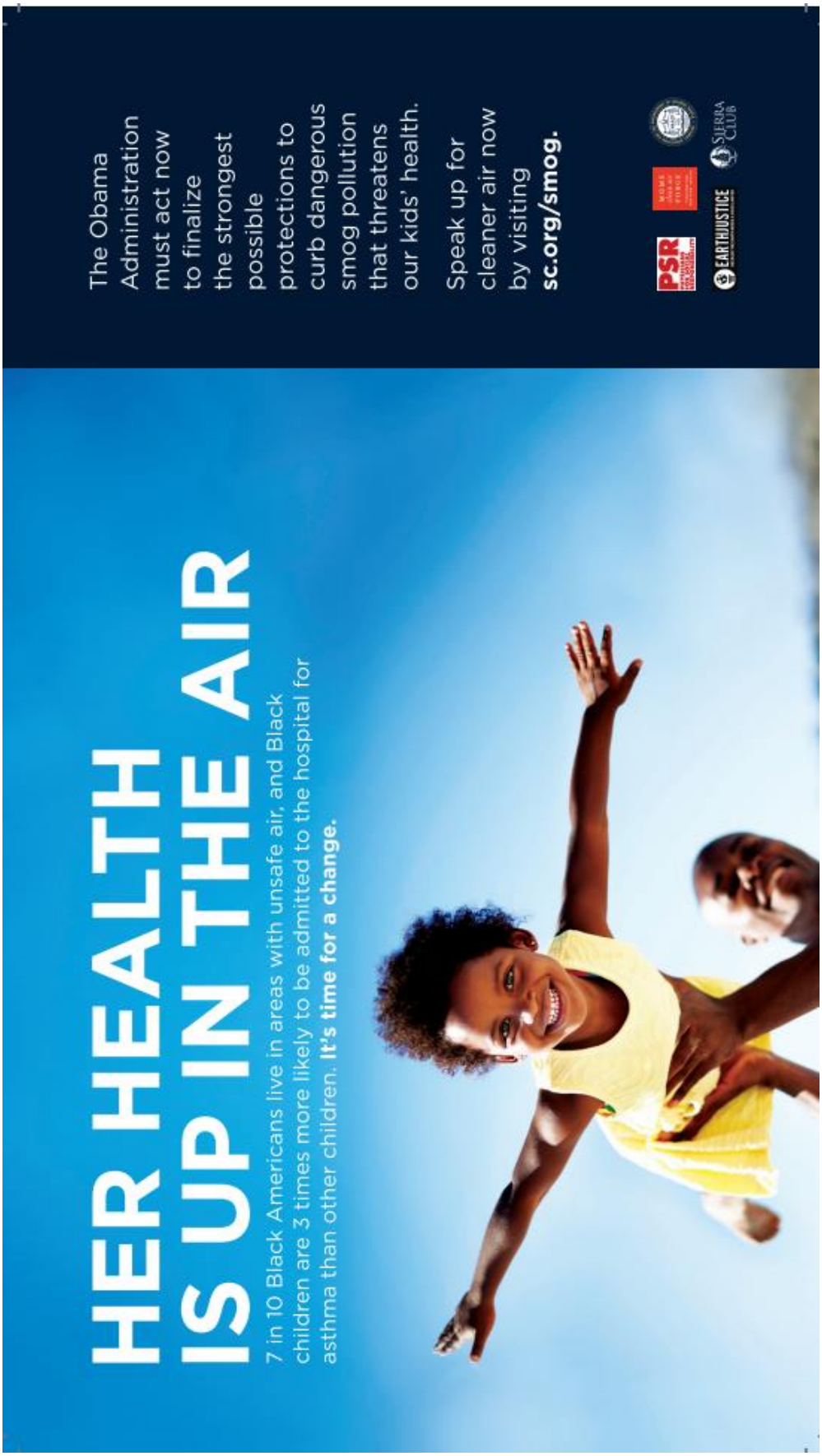
Lisa: Oh, sure, here it is. By the way, Brett, will you lend me twenty bucks?

II - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

INTERPRETING THE ADS

Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.




HER HEALTH
IS UP IN THE AIR
7 in 10 Black Americans live in areas with unsafe air, and Black children are 3 times more likely to be admitted to the hospital for asthma than other children. It's time for a change.
The Obama Administration must act now to finalize the strongest possible protections to curb dangerous smog pollution that threatens our kids' health.
Speak up for cleaner air now by visiting sc.org/smog.
PSR
EARTHJUSTICE
SIERRA CLUB

Ford's fine line of cars never stops rolling...

1969 MUSTANG MACH I

It's the going thing!

. . . and one of the reasons is that Ford has consistently taken the lead with Better Idea cars like Thunderbird, Mustang, Falcon and Torino. Pacesetting styling, engineering breakthroughs—Ford has a lot of Better Ideas to talk about. And these Better Ideas are reflected in added value on the used car lot . . . with Ford, it's the Going Thing.

MUSTANG Ford

THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete statements one through four based on that ad.

1. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
2. It is important to many Americans to…
3. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
4. This ad would / wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because …
5. The ad that I liked the best is …
6. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS
USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech.

In some African countries, elephants are near extinction because they are hunted and killed for their ivory tusks, which are then sold for marginal profit on the black market. Beyond the tragedy of greatly diminished numbers of animals, the poachers are only hurting themselves and their African brothers and sisters. As the animals, become more and more scarcer, so does the hunter potential for any further income. Furthermore, since African tourism and safaris create greater economic opportunities than selling ivory, it would be much more advantageous for the Africans to encourage protection for the elephant herds, rather than their destruction. You have been assigned to speak to a group of African tribesmen to try to convince them to help stop the killing of elephants in their homeland. Tell the tribesmen that it is for their benefit that the elephants should no longer be hunted.

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

Participate in the following discussion, using the idioms from this chapter.

Your friend is in her second year at college and is trying to decide what to choose as her major course of study. She wants to be a writer, and in fact has already won several awards for her poetry. Her parents would like her to become a teacher so that she at least will have a steady income after graduation.

Discuss the following with your group, and remember to use the idioms from this chapter in your discussion.

- Your friend's position
- Her parent's position.
- The advantages and disadvantages of writing full time.

- How her parents might feel if she signed a lucrative contract with a major publishing company.
- What, if anything, she could do to please her parents as well as herself.
- What you think she should do.

C. DEBATE: SCHOOL FOR PAY

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following question: Should some students get paid for attending school? Before you begin, jot down the arguments supporting your position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

East Hills High School is similar to many other high schools around the country. Although most students complete their education, many drop out before they graduate. Because of this problem, an innovative program at East Hills was designed to keep students in school. At-risk students – those who have previously had trouble staying in school – are paid five dollars for everyday they attend all their classes on time, do all their homework and come prepared to class. The program seems to be effective for those students it has targeted, but there has been a protest launched by the students who have never had problems and therefore don't get paid.

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (priest, prisoner)
PRIEST: You believe that everyone should have a chance to change his or her life, even convicted criminals. You talk to prisoners every day, asking if they want to confess their sins, and encouraging them to repent.

PRISONER: Before you were in prison, you didn't care about anyone but yourself. Now that you´ve had some time to think about all people you´ve hurt, you feel very bad, and you see things from a different perspective.

2. (defense attorney, prosecutor. Review the article to help you build your case.)

DEFENSE ATTORNEY: You are defending two southeast Asian clients who have been charged with cruelty to animals for killing their dog for food. Construct your case carefully, and convince the jury that they are innocent.

PROSECUTOR: You believe that the two men who killed their dog to eat it are guilty of cruelty to animals. Even though they are not Native Americans, they should be bound by the same laws as everyone else. You must convince the jury of this.

E. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

The following story is only half-written. Read it carefully, and decide how it ends. Then finish writing the story, using the idioms from this chapter.

Shortly after her father died, Nadine suggested to her husband, Randall, that they invite her mother to live with them. Although they didn't have a lot of room, Randall willingly agreed, and soon Nadine's mother moved in. It wasn't long before Randall regretted the invitation; his mother-in-law making life absolutely miserable for him. He didn't even want to come home after work because he hated her constant complaining and their total lack of privacy. However, Randall realized that Nadine felt much better knowing that her mother was not alone. Nadine also appreciated her mother's help around the house and with the children. Randall didn't know what to do, but he decided that he must speak to Nadine about the problem before another day went by…

F. ADVERTISING WITH IDIOMS

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience – the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from this chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present in to the class. Do you think this ad would appeal to the other members of your class?

2

ROMANCE

IDIOMS

- HEAD OVER HEELS IN LOVE
- STARS IN ONE'S EYES
- PUT SOMEONE ON A PEDESTAL
- FEEL TEN FEET TALL
- LOOK LIKE A MILLION BUCKS
- PROMISE THE MOON
- LAY IT ON THICK
- BREATHING ROOM
- NO STRINGS ATTACHED
- KNOW WHERE ONE STANDS
- GET SOMEONE OFF ONE'S MIND
- GIVE SOMEONE A RING

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

FEEL TEN FEET TALL

To feel happy, fortunate, and self- confident.

Example: The applause made the actor feel ten feet tall.

GET SOMETHING/SOMEONE OFF ONE'S MIND

To be unable to stop thinking about someone or something; to think of something or someone constantly. This idiom is always used in the negative.

Example: I can't get that news report off my mind. The story about the Siamese twins was fascinating.

You may substitute it for something/someone.

Example: I saw a fascinating new report about Siamese twins. I can't get it off my mind.

GIVE SOMEONE A RING

To call someone on the telephone. The placement of the object cannot vary; you cannot give a ring to Joe. for example; you must give Joe a ring.

Example: Why don't you give me a ring when you get home?

HEAD OVER HEELS IN LOVE

Very much in love. You can be head over heels in love with someone, or simply head over heels in love.

Example: Mary and Bob are head over heels in love.

Sometimes in love is omitted from the expression; it is understood without being explicitly stated.

Example: Are they really in love with each other? Oh, yes! Head over heels!

KNOW WHERE ONE STANDS

To know how someone feels about you; to understand another's expectations in a relationship. This is used in cases where the speaker is confused about

the nature of his/her relationship with another person. Be sure to make one agree with the subject.

Example: "I need to know where I stand with you."

LAY IT ON THICK

To flatter or praise someone excessively. Don't try to substitute anything else for it in this expression.

Example: The movie producer kept telling her that she was the best actress he had ever seen. Boy, was he laying it on thick?

LOOK LIKE A MILLION BUCKS

To look great; to be attractive and well-dressed.

Example: Did you see Tom Cruise in his latest movie? He looked like a million bucks in that black leather jacket!

NO STRINGS ATTACHED

With no commitment or conditions set.

Example: I told him I was willing to review his case with no strings attached. Neither one of us was bound to sign a contract until I finished the review.

PROMISE THE MOON

To promise someone something that is impossible.

The placement of the indirect object can be varied or omitted entirely.

I wish I could promise <u>you</u> the moon. **OR**

I wish I could promise the moon <u>to you</u>. **OR**

I wish I could promise the moon.

PUT SOMEONE ON A PEDESTAL

To be in awe of someone; to believe that he/she can do no wrong. This expression may be used in the passive voice.

Example: Elvis Presley was put on a pedestal throughout his career, so it was a shock to his fans when he died of a drug overdose.

STARS IN ONE'S EYES

To have feelings of great happiness and excitement (usually caused by being in love).

Example: Teresa smiled at Sam after class today, and he walked around all afternoon with stars in his eyes.

This idiom is also sometimes used to describe someone who is obsessed with show business.

Example: I've always wanted to be an actress. I guess you could say I've got stars in my eyes.

BREATHING ROOM

To have freedom from excessive control of one's time and attention. This idiom is often used with some, or in the negative.

Example: I can't get any work done with you talking to me all the time. Give me some breathing room!

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

Warming Up

In small groups of only men and only women, discuss the following questions. Then compare the men's responses to the women's. How are they similar? How are they different? What accounts for those similarities or differences?

1. How accurate are your first impressions of the people you meet? Do you find that you often change your opinion of a person after knowing him/her for some time? Do your later impressions usually change for the better or the worse? Do you think men or women have more accurate first impressions of the people they meet?

2. What are the first things that you notice when you meet someone of the opposite sex? Make a list of five items, and rank them in order of importance.

3. Which of those items on your list do you think would continue to be important to you in a long-term relationship?

4. Do you believe in "love at first sight"? Explain.

5. Agree or disagree with the following statements:

- Women have a fundamental need to feel dependent on men.
- Women are attracted to men who take a dominant role in the relationship.
- Women are more emotional than men.
- Men are more rational than women.
- It is better to be single than to be married.

6. Discuss the following situation with your group.

Chantal and Hans met in English class and began spending time together. At first, they were just helping each other study, but soon they became romantically involved. Hans is falling in love with Chantal. Chantal isn't sure how she feels about Hans because she left her boyfriend, Antoine, to come to study in The United States. Last night, Antoine called and told her that he would be coming to visit her in two days. Hans doesn't know anything about Antoine. Tonight, Chantal is having dinner with Hans. What should she do?

GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. READING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Read to the following two letters, written by a man and woman who just met each other. They are asking two of their friends for advice on how to deal with

their relationship. Consider these questions as you read to the letters. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. What happened the evening that John and Tina met? Describe how you think the evening went from the moment they saw each other to when they said good-bye.

_____
_____
_____

2. Can you imagine this kind of an encounter happening in your native country?

_____
_____
_____

3. How does John feel about Tina? How does Tina feel about John?

_____
_____
_____

4. If you were Ted, what advice would you give John? If you were Lori, what advice would you give to Tina?

_____
_____
_____

5. Do you think that John and Tina will become romantically involved? Why or why not?

_____
_____
_____

B. IDENTIFYING THE IDIOMS

Next, read the article to which you have just read. Throughout this article you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

__Look like a million bucks
__Feel tan feet tall
__Head over heels in love
__Promise (someone) the moon
__Stars in one's eyes
__Put someone on a pedestal
__Breathing room
__Lay it on thick
__Know where one stands
__No strings attached
__Give someone a ring
__Get someone/ something off one's mind

HEAD OVER HEELS

Dear Ted,

I wish you were here, instead of a thousand miles away. I've really got to talk to you! You know me better than anybody, so what I have to say may shock you. Ted, I'm head over heels in love with a girl I only met last night. It may seem crazy, but I don't even want to see anyone else. You may think it's a little early to make such an important decision, but I'm telling you, this is it! I know it sounds like I've got stars in my eyes, but you would understand if you saw her. I just can't get her off my mind. As soon as I saw her walk into the party, I knew she was something special. She looked like a million bucks-long black hair, big grey eyes, wearing a fabulous green dress-I knew I had to

meet her. We spent most of the evening together, and then she came over to my place after the party and we talked for hours. She made me feel ten feet tall – I can't remember ever feeling so happy. Finally, she said she had to go. I wanted to ask her to stay with me forever, but I need to make sure she feels the same way. I've got to know where I stand! I know I can't promise her the moon, but I would give her my best. So, what do you think? Ted, write soon. This is serious, and I need your advice.

Your buddy, John.

Dear Lori,

I tried calling you this morning, but your line was busy, so I thought I'd write you a note instead. We need to talk! I hope you're not working late today, because I'm counting on you to give some good advice.

Remember that guy left the party with last night? His name is John. He's very nice, and I think he really likes me. I guess there's nothing wrong with that, but he barely knows me, and I hate it when guys put me on a pedestal. It's so much harder to have a normal relationship with someone who thinks you're perfect - Don't you agree? Anyway, he got serious pretty fast last night, and we had only just met! He told me that I was just right for him, and that he'd never been with anyone so beautiful, and we'd make a wonderful couple, and on and on. He was really laying it on thick. It's all very nice to hear, but I'm just not ready to get involved with anyone right now. I need some breathing room, you know? I'd like to take it slow – slow maybe go out with him now and then, with no strings attached. He promised he'd call me today, and I don't know what to tell him. So, what do you think? Give me a ring as soon as you get home!

See you, Tina

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following statements. Pay attention to how the idiom is used, and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding letters. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line.

The first one is done for you.

1. They story of Romeo and Juliet is so romantic!

Imagine being **head over heels in love** like they were!

EX: Very much in love

2. When Ben and Maggie talk about each other, they have **stars in their eyes.** You can tell they just got married.

_____

_____

_____

3. When I visited Linda in the hospital last week, I saw a little boy who was seriously ill. He had such a sad look on his face. Since then, I haven't been able to **get him off my mind.**

_____

_____

_____

4. Tom bought a new gray pinstripe suit and an expensive Italian silk tie for his job interview. **He looked like a million bucks!**

_____

_____

_____

5. Jeannie studied all night for her geography test. When the grades were posted, she **felt ten feet tall**. She was the only one to get 100 percent.

_____

_____

_____

6. Clyde keeps telling me that he just wants to be my friend, but when I make a date with another guy, he gets really jealous. I don't understand; I've got to find out **where I stand** with him.

_____

_____

_____

7. Henry Stone made millions of dollars by telling people that they would become very rich if they invested in his company. He **promised them the moon**, but nobody else made a penny.

_____

_____

_____

8. It's hard to believe that Michael Jackson is a person just like everyone else. Because he is so famous, he has **been put on a pedestal** his whole life.

_____

_____

_____

9. Marle has sold more encyclopedias than anyone. First, she **lays it on thick** by telling her customers how intelligent and sophisticated they are. After that, they are all willing to buy anything from her.

_____

_____

_____

10. Sadie is having a difficult time at work. Her boss controls practically every movement she makes. If he doesn't give her some **breathing room,** I think she'll quit her job.

_____

_____

_____

11. Lee has already been divorced, so she's not anxious to get married again. Even though she sees Joe quite often, she says there are **no strings attached**.

_____

_____

_____

12. I'm sorry my line was busy last night. Why don't you **give a ring** this evening, and we can talk then.

_____

_____

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Decide if the sentence that corresponds to each is true or false. Circle T if it is true and F if it is false.

1. T/F Doug married the woman he loves.
2. T/F Marty probably wanted to see Ken again.
3. T/F I have been singing that song over and over again in my mind.
4. T/F Sergeant Gibbs is probably very wealthy.
5. T/F Only tall women win the Miss America pageant.
6. T/F Kurt doesn't know where his girlfriend is.
7. T/F Dr Carter isn't able to guarantee a cure for cancer yet.
8. T/F Police officers are expected to be more honest than other people.
9. T/F Steward didn't care what she thought of him.
10. T/F Lena thinks her parents are too strict with her.
11. T/F The car is usually tied down with strings to prevent theft.
12. T/F Darry wasn't sure whether or not he should give his girlfriend her wedding ring.

E. RETELLING THE STORY – OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the letters again. The sentences below refer to statements in those letters. On the lines below, restate the sentences, using the appropriate idiom. The first one is done for you.

1. John was deeply in love with Tina, even though they had only just met.
John was head over heels in love with Tina, even though they had only just met.
2. John was totally infatuated with Tina.

_____

3. He couldn't stop thinking about her.

_____

4. Tina looked great! She was beautiful and dressed very attractively.

_____

5. Tina made John feel wonderful when he was with her.

_____

6. John wanted to know how Tina felt about him.

_____

7. He knew that he couldn't guarantee that everything in their future would be perfect, but he would try.

_____

8. Tina felt that John wasn't treating her like a normal person; it was as if she were perfect.

_____

9. John spent the evening telling Tina how beautiful she was and how great everything would be if they were together.

_____

10. Tina needed to feel a sense of independence. She didn't want to be with one person all the time.

_____

11. She wanted an open relationship, in which she was not bound by any commitment or promises about the future.

_____

12. Tina wanted Lori to call her on the phone when she got home.

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

Natalie and Jake are two characters on the popular soap opera, "Nights of Our Lives." They are rehearsing a scene for the next show, but they keep forgetting their lines. Complete the dialogue with sentences. Remember to change the idioms as needed to fit the sentences.

Natalie: Oh, darling, I can't go on like this any longer. One day you say you love me and the next day you don't._____ **(know where one stands).**

Jake: Natalie, you're a beautiful woman and you take great care of yourself. _____**(look like a million bucks)** You're intelligent and charming and talent. Most men would die for your love. But …

Natalie: Stop it!_____**(lay it on thick).** Say what you really mean.

Jake: I just don't know what I want right now. Maybe I should get away and be by myself for a while _____**(breathing room).**

Natalie: Oh, Jake, please don't leave me! I don't know what I would do without you. If you were gone, I'd go crazy!_____**(get someone off one's mind)**

Jake: Natalie, please come down. I'm not the man you think I am. _____**(put someone on a pedestal)**. You could easily find someone much better for you than I am.

Natalie: No, no, no! Don't do this to me, Jack! You know I can't live without you! When we're together,_____**(feel ten feet tall).** And it wasn't so long ago that you felt the same way**.**_____**(stars in one's eyes).**

Jake: You're right. When I first met you, things were great. We were younger then, and more innocent**.**_____**(head over heels in love)**. But everything has changed. Our relationship is very different now.

Natalie: Jack, can't we try again?_____**(with no strings attached)**

Jake: I don't know, Natalie._____**(promise someone the moon)**. I need time to think.

Natalie: OK, Jake, but don't be gone too long. I'll be waiting to hear from you. _____. **(Give someone a ring).**

II - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

INTERPRETING THE ADS

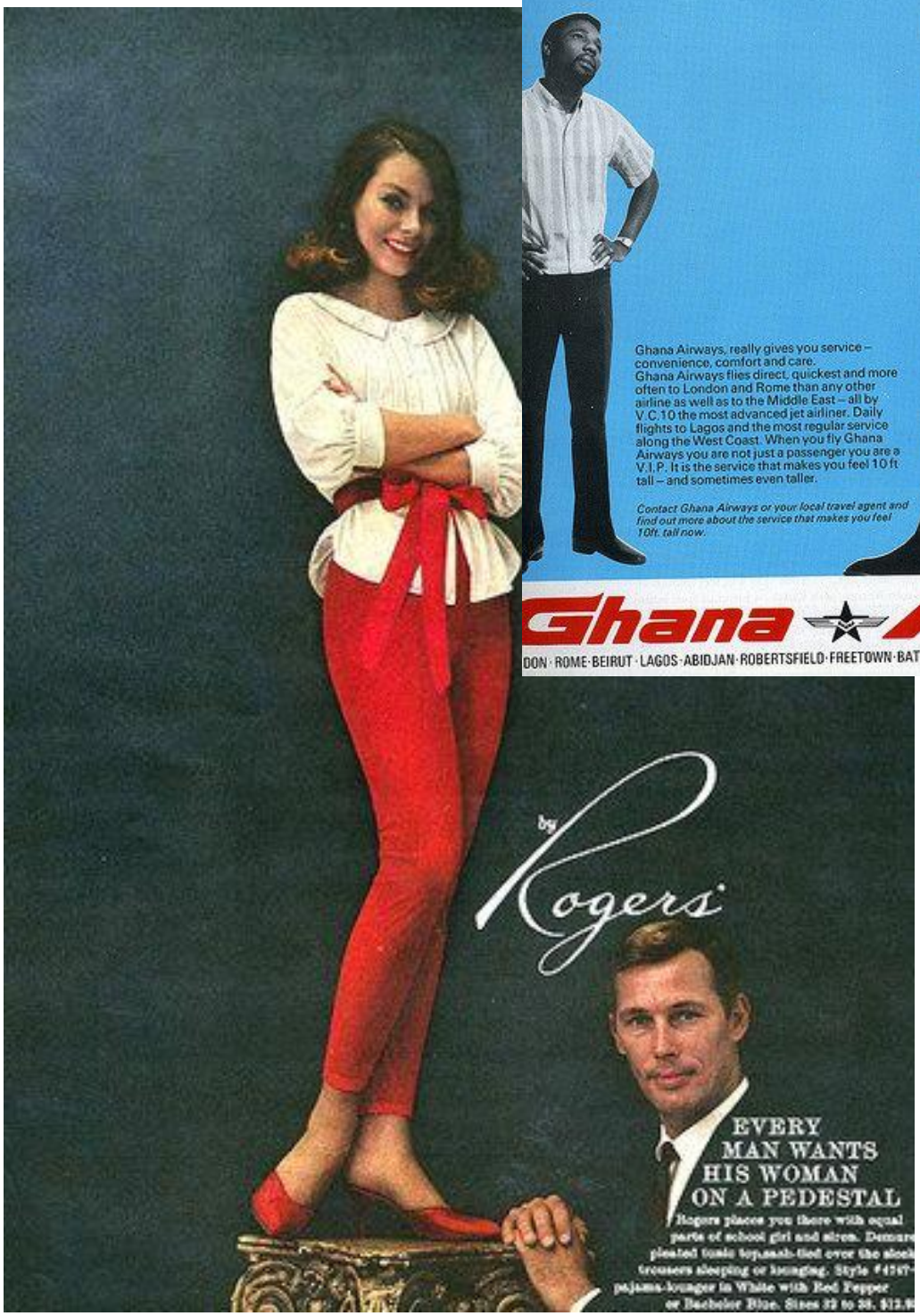
Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.

Darling, I'm tickled pink all over—
I'm head over heels
in New Pink Dove!
Dove
pink
Dove
Dove
Yes, darling, Pink Dove!
New pink color, heavenly new fragrance—
same creamy Dove formula!
Pink Dove, like white Dove, is ¾ cleansing cream. It creams your skin while you wash.

YOU CAN'T EXPECT
TO LOOK LIKE A
MILLION BUCKS
IF YOU EAT FROM
THE DOLLAR MENU

got fitness on your mind?
let us take the load off.

"Ghana Airways gives the service that makes you feel 10 feet tall"
Ghana Airways, really gives you service – convenience, comfort and care.
Ghana Airways flies direct, quickest and more often to London and Rome than any other airline as well as to the Middle East – all by V.C.10 the most advanced jet airliner. Daily flights to Lagos and the most regular service along the West Coast. When you fly Ghana Airways you are not just a passenger you are a V.I.P. It is the service that makes you feel 10 ft tall – and sometimes even taller.
Contact Ghana Airways or your local travel agent and find out more about the service that makes you feel 10ft. tall now.
Ghana Airways
DON · ROME · BEIRUT · LAGOS · ABIDJAN · ROBERTSFIELD · FREETOWN · BATHURST · DAKAR Ghana Airways, Cocoa House, Accra. Tel:


by Rogers
EVERY MAN WANTS HIS WOMAN ON A PEDESTAL

THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete statements one through four based on that ad.

1. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
2. It is important to many Americans to…
3. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
4. This ad would / wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because …
5. The ad that I liked the best is …
6. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS

USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech. You may choose to agree or disagree with the following statement: "Women generally fall in love faster than men and are more committed to a relationship." Defend your view, explaining why you agree or disagree.

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

In small groups of only men and only women, complete the following love letter by finishing the sentences that have been started for you. Not every sentence must include an idiom from this chapter, but be sure to use one wherever possible. Before you get started, decide together whose name you would like to write in the first blank.

Dearest_____,
The first time I saw you,_____
When you look at me,_____
You make me _____
I know that I will always_____
Every time I think of you _____
When I'm with you _____
Would you please _____
Love always, _____

C. DEBATE: INCOMPATIBLE MARRIAGE PARTNERS?

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following questions: Should the couple be allowed to marry? Before you begin, jot down the arguments supporting your position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

Recently there was a story in the news about a 23 year old mentally retarded man who fell in love with a 47 years old woman. The woman had been married previously and divorced, and was reportedly an alcoholic. The young man's family believed that the woman takes unfair advantage of their son, who had the mental capability of a 12years old. They believe that the pair should not be allowed to marry. The woman claimed that they could help one another and that no one should stand in the way of their love.

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (Two friends)

FRIEND A: For several months, you have been infatuated with someone who has never paid much attention to you. Finally, in hopes of making this person notice you, you dyed your hair, had plastic surgery, and started wearing wild

new clothes. In spite of your new look, he/she still is not interested. You suspect there is someone else in the person's life. You are meeting an old friend today for the first time in over a year.

FRIEND B: You are getting together with a friend whom you haven't seen in a long time. The first thing you notice is that your friend looks and acts like a completely different person. Your friend looks fabulous, but you can tell that he/she still isn't happy. As your friend talks, you realize that the person he/she is interested in is your boy/girlfriend! Oh, no! What are you going to say to your friend?

2. (John and Tina)

JOHN: You called Tina earlier today to make a date for dinner this evening. (It is the day after you meet.) She sounded kind of funny on the phone, but maybe she was just nervous. So are you. You have decided to ask her to marry you.

TINA: You are going out to dinner with John, and you aren't sure what to tell him. You would like to get to know him better, but you want him to slow down! You have your future all planned: college, a career, travels, and so on, and you are definitely not ready to settle down with one person.

USING THE IDIOMS IN WRITING

E. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

Part I

Commonly, people who need help resolving personal issues and dilemmas can write to a newspaper or magazine columnist for advice. Answer to these letters and then printed in the newspaper or magazine for everyone to read. Described below are various problems that you want the popular columnist Sally Sue to respond to. Choose one problem, and write a letter to Sally Sue in which you tell about your situation, using the idioms from this chapter.

1. You have a friend who is about to be married to a man she has known for only a month. You don't like this man, and you think that he is only marrying her for her money. Your friend admits that her boyfriend has already "borrowed" huge amounts of money, but she believes that he will pay her back after they are married. Your friend seems to be very much in love with this man and thinks he is perfect for her, even though he treats her badly, spends her money, and constantly flirts with other women.

2. You recently met a woman at a business convention who is beautiful, smart, and funny – in short, everything you've always wanted. After going out for several weeks, however, you found out that she had previously been seeing one of your friends. Your friend has been heartbroken since she broke up with him, and you know that he would be very upset to know that you are now dating her. You don't know what to do.

3. You were married for two years to a very jealous man/woman who suspected you of having an affair every time you left the house. Now that you are divorced, however, your ex-husband/ex-wife continues to call you every day and comes to your office and home all the time. Your former spouse has already ruined one relationship, and you are worried about having another for fear that your "ex" will ruin it as well.

Part II

After you have finished, exchange your letter(s) with other members of your class. Discuss solutions to the problem, and then write a letter in response from Sally Sue. Give that letter to the person who originally wrote about the problem.

F. Advertising with Idioms

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience – the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from this chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present in to the class. Do you think ad would appeal to the other members of your class?

3

PROBLEM SOLVING

IDIOMS

- OPEN A CAN OF WORMS
- BLOW IT
- IN OVER ONE'S HEAD
- KEEP A LEVEL HEAD
- CUT CORNERS
- SLIP ONE'S MIND
- TILL THE COWS COME HOME
- THROW IN THE TOWEL
- RIGHT AROUND THE CORNER
- CROSS THAT BRIGE WHEN ONE COMES TO IT
- GET SOMETHING OFF THE GROUND
- OFF THE TOP OF ONE'S HEAD
- ODDS ARE

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

BLOW IT (OR **TO BLOW SOMETHING)**
To make a big mistake; to mine one's chances; to waste one's opportunities or money.
Example: I should have told Mr. Tyson I could start work immediately, but I blew it! Now he's hired someone else.
You may substitute it with another noun.
Example: I'll give you twenty dollars if you promise not to blow your money on candy.

CROSS THAT BRIDGE WHEN ONE COMES TO IT
To deal with a situation or a problem when one has to, and not before.
Example: There's no use in worrying about what we'll do if there is a Third World War. We'll cross that bridge when we come to it.

CUT CORNERS
To compromise on quality; to do something poorly or incompletely.
Example: Many people have speculated that the space shuttle blew up because NASA cut corners when they tested the equipment.

GET SOMETHING OFF THE GROUND
Get something started or running smoothly. Something usually refers to a project, an idea, or a plan.
Example: I've spent six months trying to get my new business off the ground.

IN OVER ONE'S HEAD
Involved in something that is too difficult, complicated, or dangerous for one to handle easily. You can get or be in over your head.

Example: The drug dealers suspect that Melinda is an undercover agent, and this is her first time dealing with dangerous criminals. She's in over her head.

KEEP A LEVEL HEAD

To think calmly and rationally; to not panic.

Example: After the accident, Marty kept a level head in spite of her injuries. She made sure everyone else was OK and got all the necessary information from the other driver.

ODDS ARE

It is probable; the chances are good. This idiom usually begins the sentence or phrase.

Example: Odds are we're not going to get much sleep tonight with a party going on next door.

OFF THE TOP OF ONE'S HEAD

To think of something without looking it up or trying hard to figure it out.

Example: Off the top of your head, can you remember the fifth president of The United States?

OPEN A CAN OF WORMS

To create a whole new set of problems to deal with.

Example: Every time someone reveals a new theory on John F. Kennedy's death, it opens a can of worms.

RIGHT AROUND THE CORNER (OR **JUST AROUND THE CORNER)**

Imminent; about to happen; in the near future.

Example: I'm sure that cars will soon be obsolete. A more efficient mode of transportation is right around the corner.

SLIP ONE'S MIND

To briefly forget something that one was supposed to remember. The thing that is forgotten is always the subject of the phrase: I forgot the appointment: The appointment slipped my mind.

Example: I was going to pick up the clothes from the cleaners, but it slipped my mind.

THROW IN THE TOWEL

To quit; give up.

Example: After dancing on Broadway for twelve years, she finally threw in the towel.

TILL THE COWS COME HOME

For a very, very long time.

Example: Are you just going to read your book till the cows come home?

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

WARMING UP

Do the following activities in small groups of three to five students. Compare answers and discuss with your classmates.

1. With the other members of your group, make a list of the five best inventions or developments of the twentieth century. Put a check next to the one you think was the most significant.

2. Imagine you are living in the year 2100. How is life different from now? Discuss the ways you think life will change in the next century. Talk about school, home, life, entertainment, transportation, fashion, medicine, work and so on. Write down what you think the ten most significant changes will be. Indicate whether you think each is a change for the better or for the worse.

3. Read the following statements about life in the year 2100. Decide if you agree or disagree. Then ask three of your classmates if they agree or disagree.

- People will have to wear special clothing and oxygen masks to protect them from the poisonous environment.
- Doctors will have found a cure for most diseases, including cancer and AIDS.
- There will be a single world government.
- Parents will be able to choose the sex of their children.
- English will be the official world language.
- Much of the world will have been destroyed by the third and fourth World wars.
- The United States will no longer be one of the world's superpowers.
- People will live in space stations or on other planets.
- Robots will be as common as telephones are today.
- People will be able to travel through time.

4. If you could visit any period of time for one day, would you travel to the past or to the future? Why? Take a quick survey among your classmates to find out if they would prefer going forward or backward in time. Is the past or the future more popular? Why? How far or forward would you like to go?

GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. READING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Read the following conversation between two characters in a movie about time travel. Consider these questions as you read to their conversation. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. What is Alfred trying to do? Why is it so difficult?
2. Why is Bernie so nervous and anxious for Alfred to succeed?
3. Who do you think Betsy is?
4. What do you think happened before this scene?
5. What do you think happened after Bernie put the wires together?
6. How do you think this movie will end?

B. IDENTIFYING THE IDIOMS

Next, read the script to which you have just read. Throughout this article you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

__OPEN A CAN OF WORMS
__BLOW IT
__IN OVER ONE'S HEAD
__KEEP A LEVEL HEAD
__CUT CORNERS
__SLIP ONE'S MIND
__TILL THE COWS COME HOME
__THROW IN THE TOWEL
__RIGTH AROUND THE CONER
__CROSS THAT BRIGE WHEN ONE COMES TO IT
__GET SOMETHING OFF THE GROUND
__OFF THE TOP OF ONE'S HEAD
__ODDS ARE

IN OVER THEIR HEADS

A scene from the movie time after time, a science-fiction drama about travelers through time.

BERNIE: Did you call Dr. Bleeb?

ALFRED: No, it slipped my mind.

BERNIE: It slipped your mind? Alfred, this is urgent! I've only got two more days to get back to Russia in 1867. If I don't make it, I may never see Betsy again. This is my last chance. Please don't blow it for me!

ALFRED: Bernie, I don't know if I can help you. I'm doing my best, but I think I'm in over my head this time. Time travel is too complicated, too unpredictable. If hundreds of brilliant scientists haven't been able to do it before now, I probably won't either. I'm just not sure it's possible.

BERNIE: But you said that success was right around the corner. You said that any day there would be a breakthrough. We've got the technology: someone just has to get lucky. Alfred, think of what this could do for you professionally! They'd probably hand you the Nobel Prize. And besides, Betsy's life depends on it! You have to get this project off the ground!

ALFRED: Look, Bernie, you've got to calm down. Odds are, there is no way to get there from here. But you've got to believe I'm trying. I can't cut corners; there are certain steps that I have to follow every time I try to reconfigure the neutrons, and it takes time.

BERNIE: I'm sorry, Alfred, you're right. I've got to keep a level head. I know it's not easy, but I believe if anybody can do it, you can.

ALFRED: The problem is that there is no way to predict what is going to happen each time I try something new. I could work on this till the cows come home and not come any closer than I am now to real time travel. And whenever I experiment with a different equation, there's a whole new set of problems. It's like opening a can of worms. Who knows – I might accidentally blow up the world.

BERNIE: Please don't throw in the towel. You can't give up! Think about Betsy. She's lost in another century. Think how lonely she must feel. What if we don't find her? What if we can't get there in time?

ALFRED: Don't worry about that now. We'll cross that bridge when we come to it.

BERNIE: Hey, Alfred, off the top your head, do you know what would happen if I put these two wires together? I can't tell what they're attached to.

ALFRED: **NO! DON'T TOUCH THOSE WI…**

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following statements. Pay attention to how the idiom is used,and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding conversation. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line. The first one is done for you.

1. I was going to get the car keys from my husband, but
It slipped my mind.
To forget something you were supposed to remember.

2. The crash at the air show was apparently the result of pilot error. He should have pulled out of his dive earlier, but **he blew it**.

_____

3. I don't understand a thing in my chemistry class. I'm definitely **in over my head**.

_____

4. We have the technology now to create an artificial environment, so space cities seem to **be right around the corner**.

_____

5. There's a lot of opposition to the school's bilingual program. We'll need more parental support to **get it off the ground**.

_____

6. Don't worry about the stain on the tablecloth. **Odds are** no one will even notice it.

_____

7. After one floor of the Lakeview Hotel collapsed, the owners realized that the construction company had tried to save time and money by **cutting corners**.

_____

8. If the lawyers start attacking your testimony, remember to **keep a level head**. Try to think and answer their questions clearly and calmly.

_____

9. I'm sure Joe is not coming today. I could wait **till the cows come home,** and he still wouldn't be here.

_____

10. Some people say that letting women fully participate in the military would be **opening a can of worms**.

_____

11. I give up! I'm never going to get this engine to work, so I'm **throwing in the towel**.

_____

12. It's silly to worry about what you're going to wear to the dance before you've even been invited to go. You can **cross that bridge when you come to it**.

_____

13. **Off the top of your head**, can you remember the name of that movie we saw starring Robert Redford and Paul Newman?

_____

PRACTICING THE IDIOMS

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Read the choices listed below for each statement you hear. Select the sentence that best relates to the original statement, and circle the corresponding letter.

1.
a. I will be upset if you forget our anniversary.
b. You have always remembered our anniversary in the past.
2.
a. Even if Jenny makes a mistake, she'll win the medal.
b. Jenny must perform a very good dive.
3.
a. In order to fix the engine, he must put his head under the hood of the car.
b. Calvin doesn't know about engines.
4.
a. The Wright brothers designed their first successful flying machine very soon thereafter.
b. The Wright brothers invented the airplane a long time after that.
5.
a. We're going to have to move it to a different location.
b. We need a lot of help from members of the community.
6.
a. A majority of people will probably vote for the president.
b. It seems evident that the public is dissatisfied with the current administration.

7.
a. You must allow time for the dough to rise.
b. The corners on each loaf of bread should be even and smooth.
8.
a. If Gina had not been thinking clearly, we might still be lost!
b. We were all calm and unworried except Gina.
9.
a. I would probably do poorly on the test anyway.
b. It's best to study late at night.
10.
a. Cindy is hesitant to talk about her divorce.
b. Her reaction is likely to be very negative: you'll wish you hadn't asked.
11.
a. Louis quit trying to get a date.
b. The women ignored Louis's request for a clean towel.
12.
a. You can travel after your grandfather is gone.
b. You shouldn't be concerned about his death before it actually happens

E. RETELLING THE STORY – OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the movie script. The sentences below refer to statements in that script. On the lines below, restate the sentences using the appropriate idiom. The first one is done for you.

1. When Bernie asks Alfred if he called Dr. Bleeb, Alfred says that he forgot.
When Bernie asks Alfred if he called Dr. Bleeb, Alfred replies that it slipped his mind
2. Bernie is very concerned that Alfred will ruin his chances of seeing Betsy again.

_____

3. Alfred thinks he is involved in something that is beyond his ability to control.

_____

4. Bernie is under the impression that success is imminent.

_____

5. In order to save Betsy, they have to launch their time travel experiment successfully.

_____

6. There is a good chance that time travel is impossible.

_____

7. In order to conduct his experiments properly, Alfred simply cannot compromise his standards; he has to complete every step thoroughly and correctly.

_____

8. Bernie needs to calm down and think rationally.

_____

9. It is possible that Alfred might work on his project for a very, very long time without finding a solution.

_____

10. Every time Alfred tries a different approach, he has to contend with another, different, set of problems.

_____

11. Bernie does not want Alfred to quit.

_____

12. If they don't succeed, Alfred and Bernie will figure out what to do about Betsy when the time comes.

_____

13. Bernie asks Alfred if he happens to know what would occur if he put two wires together.

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

You are part of a volunteer rescue team that has been sent out to look for a group of lost hikers up in the mountains. The hikers left yesterday morning and were expected back within five or six hours, but they never returned to their camp. Now their families and friends are very worried that something terrible might have happened to them. You must find them before it's too late! The leader of your rescue party has given you some instructions. Substitute one of the idioms listed below for each of the numbered phrase. Remember to change the idioms as needed to fit the sentences.

CUT CORNERS
IN OVER ONE'S HEAD
BLOW IT
RIGHT AROUND THE CORNER
OFF THE TOP ONE'S HEAD
CROSS THE BRIDGE WHEN ONE COMES TO IT
OPEN A CAN OF WORMS
ODDS ARE
TILL THE COWS COME HOME
GET SOMETHING OFF THE GROUND
THROW IN THE TOWEL
SLIP ONE'S MIND
KEEP A LEVEL HEAD

First of all, I'd like to thank you for coming. Without your help, this rescue operation could never _____(1.get started). I hope this won't take long; if we all do what we're supposed to, the hikers rescue should be _____(2.here soon). Remember that you're searching for very inexperienced hikers, so they

are probably _____(3.unable to deal with the situation). They really _____ (4.made a big mistake) when they left the marked trail, and by now they have realized that by wandering off without a map or guide, they have _____ (5. lost control of the situation). _____(6.chances are pretty good) that they are scared. _____(7. They probably forgot) to take enough food and supplies for more than a few hours, so you should also expect them to be cold and hungry. Obviously, the most important thing to do while you're looking for them is to _____(8. Remain calm and think clearly). Make sure that you search the area carefully and methodically. You must not _____(9. Do an incomplete job); their lives depend on you. Everyone is equipped with two-way radios, so you can let the others know if you find anything. And if you happen to think of something _____(10. Spontaneously) that you believe might help, tell the other volunteers as soon as possible. We will continue to search _____(11. Until very late), so please don't _____ (12. Quit) until everyone has been found. If we don't find them tonight … well , we'll _____(13. Decide what to do when that time comes). Good luck!

II - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

INTERPRETING THE ADS

Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.

IN GOD WE TRUST
LIBERTY
2009
C
LUCKY PENNY
Trolli
SOUR BRITE
Crawlers
CAN O' WORMS
Worms!

I'LL
LOVE YOU
TILL THE
COWS COME
HOME
KATHRYN CRISTALDI
KRISTYNA LITTEN

IT JUST TASTES BETTER
BURGER KING
IT'LL BLOW
YOUR MIND AWAY
$6.25 MEAL
BK SUPER SEVEN INCHER

Keep Fighting!!!
Sweats And Tears May Flow,
But Please... Don't Throw
In The Towel.
@memorinken

THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete one through four based on that ad.

1. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
2. It is important to many Americans to…
3. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
4. This ad would/wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because
5. The ad that I liked the best is …
6. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS

USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech.

Think of a time in your life when you had to go through a difficult, frightening, or painful experience (for example, sustaining a physical injury, being in a car accident, being threatened by someone, facing an unusual challenge at work or school). Can you describe the situation? What did you do? Do you think you handled the problem well? How was the situation resolved? Explain your experience to the other members or your group.

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

Participate in the following discussion, using the idioms from this chapter.

Shipwrecked! Your wonderful vacation on a luxurious cruise ship came to an abrupt end when the ship ran into a submerged rock started to sink. You and the other members of your group were able to jump into a lifeboat, but it's not very sturdy, and you don't know how long you can last out in the middle of the ocean. You and your fellow travelers are split into two groups: those who are optimistic about your chances of survival, and those who are pessimistic and don't think you can make it. Decide who will be on either side, and discuss the following questions:

- When do you think you will be rescued?
- How will you stay alive until help comes?
- How will you ration the small amount of water and food in the lifeboat?
- What are your chances of survival?
- What will you do if you are not found soon?

C. DEBATE: GENETIC ENGINEERING

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following questions: Should Genetic engineering be allowed? Before you begin, jot down the arguments supporting your position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

Through recent advances in a technical field call genetic engineering, scientists have been able to manipulate the DNA, or genetic material of life, so that they can in effect create new life form in a laboratory. This ability to change genetic molecules for various purposes has been the subject of much controversy.

Proponents of genetic engineering say that it offers the hope of a permanent cure for many inherited illnesses. It makes possible the growth of "perfect" fruits, vegetables and other foods that are resistant to disease or decay.

Genetically altered bacteria provide a common treatment for cancer.

These are only a few examples of what is in might be possible in this new and exited field. Scientists are only beginning to realize the tremendous potential of this technology.

However, not everyone agrees that this field should be explored any further. While the benefits may be considered, genetic engineer is also potentially very dangerous.

If genes can be altered in "good" ways, so can they be changed to create new diseases and new environment hazards? Opponents say that genetic engineering is "playing God" and that all life forms, even imperfect ones, should be left alone.

They say that humans cannot possibly accurately estimate the result of consequences of experimentation with the genes of living organisms, and that it is only a matter of time before something disastrous happens.

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you

can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (Two friends)

FRIEND A: You love to play the lottery! Although you have never actually won anything, you are sure you will hit the jackpot very soon. It's true that you do spend a whole lot of money on your hobby, but you firmly believe that if you play long enough, you will get rich.

FRIEND B: Your friend can't understand how much control this urge to gamble has on his/her life. Try to convince your friend to think rationally about what he/she is doing; the chances of winning any money at all are very slight. If your friend wants to get rich, there's no way to take shortcuts; one must just work hard like the rest of society, and not waste any more money on the lottery! Your friend might play every day for a lifetime and not make a dime! Tell your friend to quit now, before it's too late.

2. (Alfred and Bernie.)

ALFRED: You told Bernie not to touch those wires! Now he has really made a mess of things! He made a big mistake, and you don't think your chances of fixing it are very good. What are you going to do? Talk to Bernie about your situation.

BERNIE: You must remain calm. There must be some way out of this mess, but you can't think of what it might be. If you and Alfred work together, you can probably get things back to the way they were. Discuss your situation with Alfred.

USING THE IDIOMS IN WRITING

E. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

Write a letter in response to the situation described below, using as many idioms from this chapter as possible.

You are the agent for a very talented and promising musician. It seems evident to you that very soon your client will be a huge star but it is very difficult to get started in the music industry, and so far the musician has had no luck. You were aware that your client was feeling quite discouraged, but still you were quite surprised to receive the following letter from him/her.

May 07, 1995
Mr. David Bashaw
Beautiful Noise Industries

Dear Mr. Bashaw:

I appreciate very much the work you've done on my behalf during the past four years. You have contacted most of the major recording studios, introduced me to some very influential people in the business, sent out dozens of demo tapes that I recorded, and widely publicized my music in other ways as well. I don't doubt that you have done your job quite thoroughly. However after all this time, I still have not been able to get a recording contract. I will have a hard time paying my bills if I feel that it's time to move on with my life, I hereby notify you that I must terminate my association with your agency. Thank you for all of your help. I wish you better luck with your other clients.

Sincerely, Chris Jenkins

How will you respond? Should you encourage your client to keep on trying, or do you agree that it is time to give up?

F. Advertising with Idioms

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience – the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from this chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present in to the class. Do you think ad would appeal to the other members of your class?

EPBL®
English Practice Based Learning

4

MAKING AN IMPRESSION

IDIOMS

- MAKE A MARK
- TAKE CENTER STAGE
- HANDS DOWN
- HAVE A CORNER ON SOMETHING
- STRIKE A CHORD
- FEATHER IN ONE'S CAP
- AHEAD OF ONE'S TIME
- BRING TO ONE'S FEET
- PUT ONE'S NAME ON THE LINE
- RAISE EYEBROWS
- OFF THE BEATEN PATH
- WARM UP TO
- HAND OVER FIST
- FLASH IN THE PAIN

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

AHEAD OF ONE'S TIME

New or revolutionary in concept; an idea that is at first met with resistance and doubt and is later widely accepted.

Example: Leonardo da Vinci was ahead of his time when he made diagrams of flying machines based on true principles of aerodynamics.

BRING TO ONE'S FEET

To provoke cheers and applause from a standing audience.

Example: The appearance of their leader brought the union members to their feet.

This idiom is sometimes used figuratively to indicate enthusiastic approval of someone or something.

Example: The birth of the king and queen's first son brought the country to its feet.

FEATHER IN ONE'S CAP

An accomplishment of which one can be very proud.

Example: After staying home and raising a family for seventeen years, Patricia went back to college to finish her degree. That diploma was a real feather in her cap.

FLASH IN THE PAN

Someone or something that experiences fleeting and transitory fame or popularity.

Example: Rubik's cubes were a flash in the pan; after a short burst of popularity, they almost immediately disappeared from the market.

HAND OVER FIST

Very quickly and in large amounts. This idiom is almost always preceded by a phrase having to do with making money.

Example: She made a fortune hand over fist by selling her collection of rare coins and stamps.

HAVE A CORNER ON SOMETHING

To have a monopoly on something.

Example: Hollywood no longer has a corner on good movies. Foreign films are becoming more sophisticated and are increasingly popular.

Something is often replaced by the market.

Example: For a long time IBM had a corner on the market of personal computers.

HANDS DOWN

Easily, without a doubt.

Example: Laura won the speech contest hands down. She gave the best speech I've ever heard.

MAKE A MARK

To have a significant impact on something.

Example: Even after thirty years, some of the people Sally taught in first grade still remember her. She really made a mark on her students.

OFF THE BEATEN PATH

Different, unusual, or unfamiliar. This idiom can be used in the more literal sense to mean a place that is not well known or traveled.

Example: We don't want to go to Hawaii on our honeymoon; we're hoping to go someplace off the beaten path.

Or it can refer to someone's ideas or behavior.

Example: I thought the professor's theories were interesting, although they're not widely accepted. He's a little off the beaten path.

PUT ONE'S NAME ON THE LINE

To risk losing one's reputation (or whatever it is that has been put on the line.)

Example: I'm willing to put my name on the line to support the new candidate for mayor.

Instead of name, you can also say reputation, job, life, money, and the like.

Example: Charles put his life on the line to rescue the dog from the burning house.

RAISE EYEBROWS

To cause disapproval, or mild shock. This idiom is often expressed as raise some eyebrows, or raise a few eyebrows.

Example: I'm sure Caroline raised some eyebrows when she refused to reveal who the father of her child was.

STRIKE A CHORD

To seem familiar; to be in agreement with one's ideas or feelings.

Example: Columbus's theory that the world was not flat struck a chord with a few other scientists of his day; there were others who also believed the world was round.

TAKE CENTER STAGE

To be the center of attention.

Example: The bride should always take center stage at her own wedding.

WARM UP TO

To accept and come to like something that one at first does not like.

Example: I know you were not impressed with Renee when you first met her, but I'm sure in time you'll warm up to her.

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

WARMING UP

1. Select three famous people from any time period. Write their names in the chart below, at the top of each of the three columns. Then walk around the classroom, asking several of your classmates to tell you one thing they know about each of the people on your list. Their comments should be brief enough to write on one line. After you have compiled a list of biographical data on your group of famous people, present the information to the class.

	Famous Person	Famous Person	Famous Person
Time Period			
Country			
Profession			
Claim to fame			
Other			

2. Think of a famous character in the history. Tell the class the initials (the first letter of the first and last name) of this character, and write those initials on the chalkboard. Your classmates will then ask you questions requiring either "yes" or "no" as an answer to try to determine who it is. For example, "Is this person alive today? " Is this a real person?" "Is this person a woman?" Whoever correctly guesses the name of the character will provide the next set of initials for the class.

3. In a small group of three to five students, make a list of ten famous people, past or present. If you had a chance to talk to these people, what questions would you ask them? Next to each name, write down one question you would ask if you could speak with that person. Share your list and question with the rest of the class.

GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. READING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Read to the following descriptions of two famous characters, and try to guess their identities. Consider these questions as you read the descriptions. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. How did Mystery Character 1 achieve fame in the film industry?
2. Why do you think some people were skeptical of his ideas?
3. What were the two major attractions that he conceived and built?
4. How long has Mystery Character 2 been around?
5. Is he still popular? With whom especially?
6. If you were going to make a cartoon character of an animal, what type of animal would you choose?

B. IDENTIFYING THE IDIOMS

Next, read the descriptions to which you have just read. Throughout these descriptions you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

__ Make a Mark
__ Take Center Stage
__ Hands Down
__ Have a Corner On Something
__ Strike a Chord
__ Feather in One's Cap
__ Ahead of One's Time
__ Bring to One's Feet
__ Put One's Name on the Line
__ Raise Eyebrows

__ Off the Beaten Path
__ Warm Up To
__ Hand Over Fist
__ Flash in The Pain

MISTERY CHARACTER 1

This is a man who recognized for his creative genius, and who revolutionized the film and entertainment industry. He was ahead of his time, when, in the early 1920s, he established his own company to produce the animated pictures for which he became famous. Soon after, he was making money hand over fist from the increasingly popular cartoon characters he had created, and he quickly had a corner on the market of animated films. Not satisfied with his early accomplishments, however, he began to envision an empire that would completely transform the world of entertainment.

After borrowing millions of dollars, he put his name on the line to bring his dreams to life, and ultimately, he succeeded in building the largest and most famous amusement park on the earth. He created a world within a world.

A place where adults could become children once again and explore the adventures, awaiting in Fantasyland, Tomorrowland or Frontier Land. Although there were many who originally thought he was too far off the beaten path to appeal to abroad audience, he effectively silenced his critics with the tremendous success of his theme park. Later, he built a similar attraction in Florida, which proved to be another feather in his cap.

During his lifetime, he also won thirty-nine Academy awards for his work in the film industry. He died in 1966, but he continues to make a mark on the world of entertainment. The empire he built keeps growing and inspiring other dreamers to believe that with a little imagination, anything is possible.

MISTERY CHARACTER 2

This is perhaps the most famous movie star of all time. He appeared in his first motion picture, steamboat Willie, in 1928, and he is even more popular today than he was back then.

Although he probably raised a few eyebrows when he was first introduced to audiences around the world, the public soon warmed up to him. His character especially struck a chord with children, and he was immediately embraced and loved by children everywhere it was not long before he could win any popularity contest hands down: there was even a television show created for his fan clubs.

Today his fame continues to spread. In fact, little statues of this extraordinary star are nearly as numerous as crucifixes and statues of Buddha, and over five thousand products in the world have his image on them. After more than a half-century of celebrity status, he has proved that he was not just a flash in the pan.

Everywhere he appears, he takes center stage; no matter in the world he goes, he brings people of all ages to their feet. Best of all, he is not selfish or egotistical like many of today's celebrities he gives full credit for his success to the man who created him, and he generously shares his fame with his wife, Minnie, and his good friends Goofy and Pluto.

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following statements. Pay attention to how the idiom is used, and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding descriptions. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line. The first one is done for you.

1. The prima ballerina Marie Taglioni was **ahead of her time** when she devised a way to dance on her toes. From that time on, ballet took on a delicate and ethereal new form.

Ex: new and revolutionary in concept

2. Fifteen years ago, I never imagined I would be making money **hand over fist** from my stock in Micromagic.

_____

3. There is no other architectural design company in this area. We've got a **corner on the market.**

_____

4. Mr. Krebs believed in the innocence of his client; otherwise he never would have **put his name on the line** to defend a convicted murderer.

_____

5. You would be foolish to listen to Jared. His ideas are always too far **off the beaten path** to be taken seriously.

_____

6. Congratulations on your big promotion! That's a real **feather in your cap!**

_____

7. Jackie Robinson **made a mark** on professional baseball when he became the first African American admitted to play in the major leagues.

_____

8. Susie's dress was rather tight fitting and low cut. I'm sure she **raised some eyebrows** at the council meeting.

_____

9. I know that Boston wasn't your first choice for finding a job, but I think that in time you'll **warm up to** the city.

_____

10. I was deeply moved by the preacher's sermon. Something about his message really **struck a chord.**

_____

11. Playing one by one, I think Michael Jordan could beat any other basketball player **hands down.**

_____

12. Everyone predicted that rock-and-roll music would be a **flash in the pan,** but it has remained popular for nearly half a century.

_____

13. I hate going out in public with my sister. With her flashy clothes and outgoing personality she **takes center stage** wherever she goes.

_____

14. The soprano in the opera was superb. She **brought the crowd to its feet** several times during the second act.

_____

PRACTICING THE IDIOMS

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Read the choices listed below for each statement you hear. Select the sentence that best relates to the original statement, and circle the corresponding letter.

1.
a. Before he started manufacturing automobiles, horse-drawn carriages were thought to be the best mode of transportation.
b. At that time the concept of traveling in automobiles was common and widespread.

2.
a. The new business James started is quite profitable.
b. The new business James started is failing.

3.
a. The Democrats lose most elections in Utah.
b. Few of the elected officials in Utah are republicans.

4.
a. The mob might have killed Anna.
b. Anna wanted to change her life, so she decided to join the protesters.

5.
a. The settlers could easily get the supplies they needed.
b. The settlement was not close to any other civilized area.

6.
a. Because she had won other awards, the Oscar nomination probably didn't mean much to her.
b. The Oscar is a very prestigious award.
7.
a. The fishers were quiet and mostly kept to themselves.
b. This community is different from the way it was before they came.
8.
a. It wasn't surprising that some members of congress were shocked at his plan.
b. Everyone was in favor of the proposal.
9.
a. You will probably really enjoy scuba diving after a while.
b. The water in the Caribbean is warmer than in other places.
10.
a. Because she deals with art all day, she is probably tired of talking about it.
b. She was very interested in what you were saying.
11.
a. The popularity styles from the sixties lasted a long time.
b. Fashion trends usually come and go very quickly.
12.
a. Eddie usually gets a lot of attention.
b. Most people don't pay any attention to six-year-old children.

E. RETELLING THE STORY – OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the descriptions again. The sentences below refer to statements in those descriptions. On the lines below, restate the sentences using the appropriate idiom. The first one is done for you.

1. Walt Disney was revolutionary in his approach to movie making.
   Walt Disney was ahead of his time in the movie industry.

2. Shortly after establishing his own production company, he was making a lot of money very quickly on his animated motion pictures.

_____

3. Soon he had a monopoly on the production of animated films.

_____

4. Disney borrowed a lot of money and risked his reputation to build Disneyland.

_____

5. Many people thought he was not in touch with the interests of the majority when he built Disneyland, but the success of the venture proved them wrong.

_____

6. The completion of Disney world in Florida proved to be an added accomplishment of which he was very proud.

_____

7. Even after his death, Walt Disney continues to have an impact on the world of entertainment.

_____

8. The character of Mickey Mouse probably caused some surprise and disapproval at first.

_____

9. Soon, however, audiences began to like him more.

_____

10. He especially appealed to children.

_____

11. He could beat any other celebrity in a popularity contest easily.

_____

12. His continuing fame has proved that Mickey Mouse is not a passing fad.

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

Read the following descriptions of famous people. First determine which of the following idioms correctly fits in the blank in each paragraph. Then, choosing from the list of characters below and try to guess who the person is.

LIST OF IDIOMS	LIST OF CHARACTERS
Hands down	***Rudolph Valentino***
Ahead of his time	***Cleopatra VII***
Took center stage	***Marco Polo***
Strike a chord	***Vincent Van Gogh***
Feather in her cap	***Lieutenant Hiroo Onoda***
Made a mark	***Elizabeth Taylor***
Flash in the Pan	***Michael Jackson***
Hand over fist	***Charles A. Lindbergh Jr.***
Raised some eyebrows	***Elvis Presley***
Put his reputation on the line	***Babe Ruth***
Have a corner on	***Henry Ford II***
Warmed Up to	***Jim Henson***
Bring audiences to their feet	***Alfred Bernhard Nobel***
Off the beaten path	***Lady Godiva***

1. This Anglo-Saxon noblewoman _____ when she persuaded her husband to lower the taxes on the people of Coventry by agreeing to ride naked on a white horse through the town.
Who is this person? _____

2. In 1983 one very famous and popular performer seemed to _____ nominations for the Grammy Award, given to the best musicians of the year in different categories. Nominated for a record-breaking twelve Grammies, he won eight – more than anyone had ever won in a single year.
Who is this person? _____

3. In 1926, a handsome Italian-born American film actor died unexpectedly at the age of thirty-one. In spite of his youth, he had

obviously_____ on the world of cinema. Over one hundred thousand fans attended his funeral, while millions more, mostly women, grieved for the loss of a romantic idol.
Who is this person? _____

4. The man who won the title of "The greatest Baseball Player in History" _____ had a habit of wearing a cabbage leaf beneath his baseball cap to keep his head cool on hot days.
Who is this person? _____

5. The inventor of dynamite earned his fortune _____ by manufacturing explosives. However, he is better known for providing in his will for the major portion of his 9 million-dollar estate to be set up as a fund to establish yearly prizes for outstanding work in such areas as physics, medicine, literature, and world place.
Who is this person? _____

6. One of the most amazing stories to come out of World War II concerns this Japanese soldier who hid in the Philippine Jungles and stayed _____ for twenty-nine years to avoid being caught. He did not know the war was over!
Who is this person? _____

7. The puppets created by this man _____ with millions of people young and old. Including such beloved characters as Kermit the Frog, Miss Piggy, and Bert and Ernie, his Muppets are world famous.
Who is this person? _____

8. After the Second World War the British offered the German Volkswagen plant to this famous car maker for free. However, because he was concerned about how the acquisition would be perceived by his fellow Americans, this man was unwilling to _____, and he refused to take it.
Who is this person? _____

9. This famous American rock-and-roll singer, known as "The King," never failed to _____ throughout his career. Few people know that he was a twin. His brother, Jessie Garon, died at birth in 1935.

Who is this person? _____

10. This man was certainly _____ when he introduced Europeans to ice cream made with milk. He had obtained the Idea from the Chinese court of Kublai Khan.
Who is this person? _____

11. Many Hollywood marriages are a _____ and are seldom expected to last long. One of the best examples of this phenomenon is that of this famous actress who has been married eight times. Two of those marriages were to the same man, Richard Burton.
Who is this person? _____

12. In 1932 the kidnapping and murder of this nineteen-month-old child_____ in the media; new reports called it "The Crime of the century". The child's father, a famous aviator and Pulitzer Prize winner, and his mother, a well-known to Europe to avoid further publicity after the Murderer was found guilty and executed.
Who is this person? _____

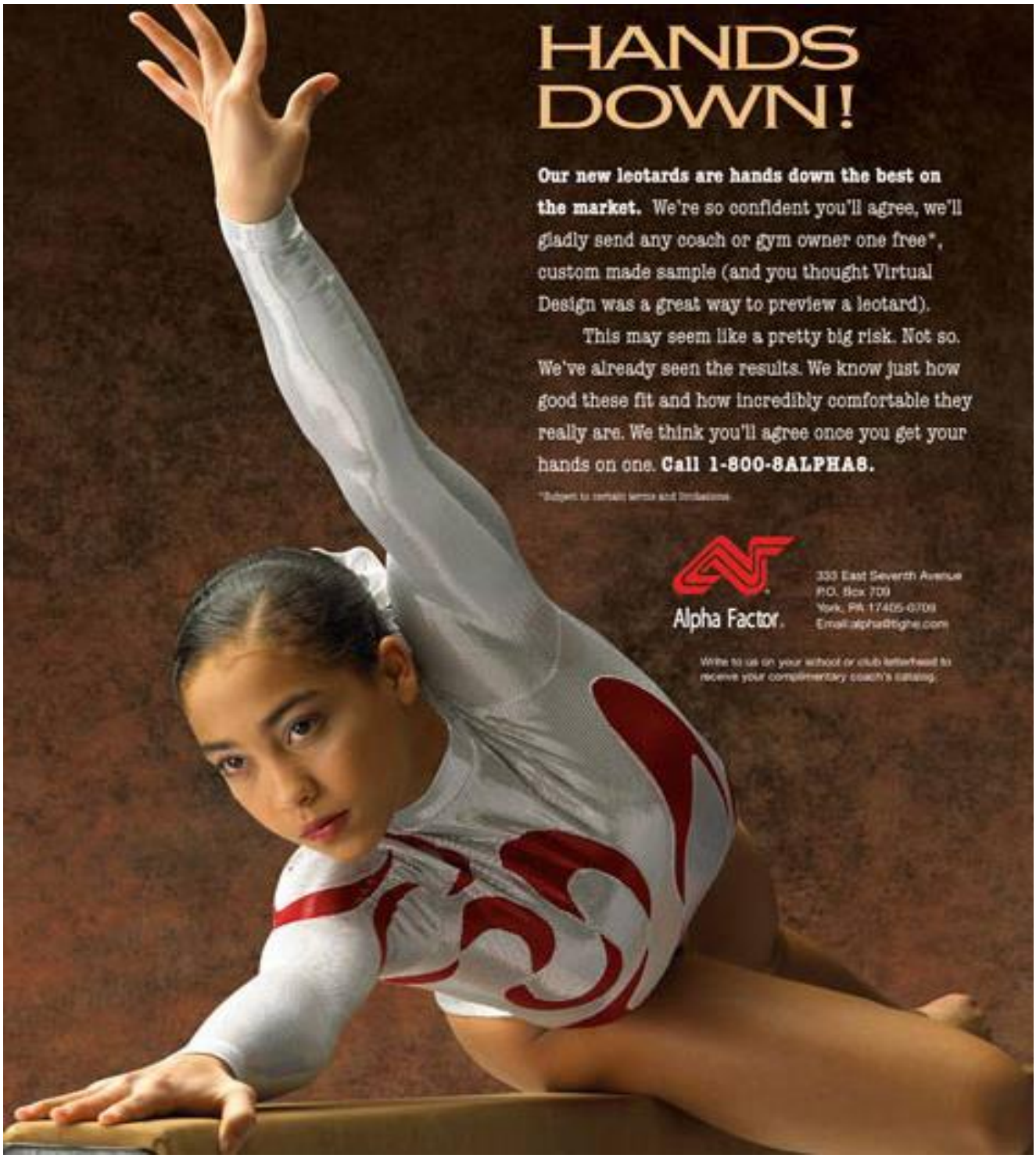
13. Although his postimpressionistic artwork was not very popular while he was living, since his death in 1890 the public has _____ this artist's innovative style and use of color. In 1990 his portrait of Dr. Gachet was auctioned off for a record $82.5 million to a Japanese businessman.
Who is this person? _____

14. She was exiled by her brother when she was twenty years old, but this woman's later triumphal return to power as the final ruler of the Ptolemy's dynasty in Egypt was a real _____. She is also famous for deciding to kill herself by snakebite hearing reports that her husband, Mark Antony, had been defeated in battle and had committed suicide.
Who is this person? _____

II - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

INTERPRETING THE ADS

Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.



make your mark | helping young people shape their future

SPEAK FRENCH

AND

ADD A FEATHER TO YOUR CAP

THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete statements one through four based on that ad.

1. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
2. It is important to many Americans to…
3. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
4. This ad would / wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because …
5. The ad that I liked the best is …
6. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS

USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech.
Think of a real or fictional character that has had a significant impact on society. You may choose from the list below, or think of one on your own. Why is this character famous? How is he/she remembered today? What do you know about this person's life? Tell about this character and his/her influence on society.

Superman	Karl Marx	Joan of Arc	Sigmund Freud
Pele	Beethoven	Charles Darwin	Marilyn Monroe
John Wayne	Leonardo da Vinci	Agatha Christie	Snoopy
Mohammed	Marie Curie	Mao Zedong	Cristopher
Socrates	Napoleon Bonaparte	Ludwig Van-Beethoven	

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

Participate in the following discussion, using the idioms from this chapter.
Edith Cromwell: age 69, Irish Immigrant, Homemaker, raised six children.
Reginald Thompson: age 26, unmarried, engineer work associates describe him as "ordinary".
Julia Miller: age 34, nightclub singer, recently spent a few months in jail on a drug charge.

The people described above, Edith Cromwell, Reginald Thompson, and Julia Miller, each did something recently to win fame and widespread publicity. They are all going to appear tonight as guests on a national television talk

show. However, the host of the show has lost his notes, and cannot remember what their extraordinary deeds were. You must write a brief summary for each person describing the following points:

- What did this person do?
- What was the public's reaction to this act?
- What effect will it have on society?
- Do you think the media attention will last long?
- What do you think is likely to happen to this person in the future?

C. DEBATE: PARAPSYCHOLOGY

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following questions: Is investing in a business to sell psychic services a good idea? Before you begin, jot down the arguments supporting your position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

The study of parapsychology has always been highly controversial. On one hand, believers cite numerous unexplained phenomena that they claim prove the existence of ghosts and extrasensory powers. On the other hand, nonbelievers point to the lack of hard evidence supporting such claims, nothing that it is nearly impossible to duplicate positive results in scientifically controlled experiments.

A close friend of yours who claims to possess psychic powers is interested in establishing a business with your help to promote and sell his services. He thinks that he could be of use in such efforts as locating lost individuals or removing ghosts from a haunted house. Your friend believes that there would be a high demand for his services and that your financial investment in this business would be very safe.

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (A biographer who is writing a book on the Beatles, a former manager of the Beatles)

BEATLES BIOGRAPHER: You are writing a book about the Beatles and the phenomenal success of their music, from the time they first appeared on the scene in 1960 until now, decades after the group broke up. During the ten years the group was together, they dominated rock music. Now you have a rare opportunity to interview one of the former managers of the band and ask him about the effect he feels the Beatles had on the young people of his generation.

FORMER BEATLES MANAGER: A lot of people disapproved of the Beatles when they got started, but obviously the world soon accepted and came to love the distinctive sound of the group. You think a lot of fans could relate to the themes of personal and political rebellion the Beatles symbolized. One of your proudest achievements was the album sergeant Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band in 1967. You feel certain the Beatles are easily the most popular rock-and-roll band of all time, and their impact on music will last a long time.

2. (Walt Disney, Mickey Mouse)

WALT DISNEY: You are proud of all of your accomplishments, but you believe that your fame has spread most through the giant amusement parks that bear your name. After all, you started with Disneyland in California, and that was followed by Disneyworld and then Disney parks in Japan and Europe – They're now spreading throughout the world! Although your cartoon characters are important, they have not had the influence that the amusement parks have. Express your point of view.

MICKEY MOUSE: Mr. Disney thinks amusement parks are more important than movies! How could he possibly believe that? It's clear that many more people see movies on a regular basis than go amusement parks! Movies are obviously more popular! And Disney movies have always had a monopoly on good family entertainment. Mr. Disney never could have succeeded when he built Disneyland had it not been that people were already familiar with his

delightful cartoon characters (such as yourself). And those characters have lasted longer and been more famous than any other characters in history. Tell Mr. Disney what you think!

USING THE IDIOMS IN WRITING

E. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

Write a report based on the situation described below, using the idioms from this chapter.

Imagine it is fifty years from now. A student in a classroom somewhere in the world is about to give a report on a famous person from the past – you! Write the report this student would give. How would you describe the challengers you faced during your lifetime? What successes did you achieve? What did you do better than anyone else for what will you be remembered? (Remember, your life isn't over – you can be as imaginative as you'd like in describing what you will do in the future.)

F. Advertising with Idioms

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience – the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from this chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present in to the class. Do you think this ad would appeal to the other members of your class?

5

FACING DEFEAT

IDIOMS

- UPHILL BATTLE
- NOT HAVE A PRAYER
- BITE OFF MORE THAN ONE CAN CHEW
- SLIP THROUGH ONE'S FINGERS
- TOO CLOSE FOR COMFORT
- SITTING DUCK
- WIPE OUT
- STOP SOMETHING IN ITS TRACKS
- TAKE IT OUT ON SOMEONE
- BRING TO ONE'S KNEES
- MISS THE BOAT
- SAVE FACE

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

BITE OFF MORE THAN ONE CAN CHEW

To try to do more than one is capable of.

Example: I'm taking too many classes this quarter; I think I bit off more than I can chew.

BRING TO ONE'S KNEES

To incapacitate; to severely weaken the power of someone; to humiliate or humble someone. The object always immediately follows bring; make sure that the possessive adjective agrees with that object.

Example: The lawsuit brought the actress to her knees; it was a long time before she worked again.

MISS THE BOAT

To lose a chance or opportunity to do something, often because one's response is too late or slow.

Example: "Did you sign up for the tour of Los Angeles?" "No, I was too late. I guess I missed the boat."

NOT HAVE A PRAYER / TO HAVE NO CHANCE AT ALL.

This idiom is always used in the negative.

Example: With his poor grades, Jason doesn't have a prayer of getting into Harvard.

SAVE FACE

To preserve one's good reputation or dignity after doing something that may potentially damage that reputation.

Example: After the scandal that had erupted in the police department, it was impossible for the chief of police to save face.

Contrast **lose face:** to lose one's dignity or ruin one's good reputation.

Save face and lose face are used without any possessive adjective; you would never say, for example, He saved his face, or I lost my face.

Example: The president of the company lost face with his employees when he was accused of cheating on his tax return.

SITTING DUCK

Someone in a vulnerable or unguarded position who is unaware of the danger of the situation.

Example: Tourists who carry a lot of cash on them are sitting ducks for the gangs of pickpockets that roam the streets.

SLIP THROUGH ONE'S FINGERS

To be lost or to narrowly escape without one knowing how.

This idiom implies that one is very close to succeeding when the objective is somehow lost.

Example: Hank went fishing yesterday, but he only caught a couple of tiny trout. He says the big ones always slip through his fingers.

TAKE IT OUT ON SOMEONE

To act in a mean, angry or hostile way toward someone, even if it is not that person's fault that you are angry.

Example: Trina was angry that the kids broke a window while they were playing baseball, and she took it out on her husband when he got home.

The actual emotion one is expressing can be used in place of it.

Example: The nurse took her frustrations out on her patients.

TOO CLOSE FOR COMFORT / DANGEROUSLY CLOSE.

Example: The speeding train nearly hit us. That was too close for comfort!

UPHILL BATTLE - A very difficult task.

Example: Trying to keep children from getting dirty is an uphill battle.

WIPE OUT
To destroy; eliminate.
Example: The army wiped out their enemies' arsenal of weapons in one strategic attack.
The object can either go between wipe and out or after wipe out.
Example: Researchers are trying to wipe cancer out, OR Researchers are trying to wipe out cancer.

STOP SOMETHING (OR **SOMEONE) IN ITS TRACKS**
To stop something or someone very abruptly or forcefully.
Example: When we moved into our new house there were millions of cockroaches, but we stopped them in their tracks with a strong insecticide.

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

WARMING UP

Interview one or two of your classmates from different countries regarding the history and origin of their native land. Use the following question as a guide.

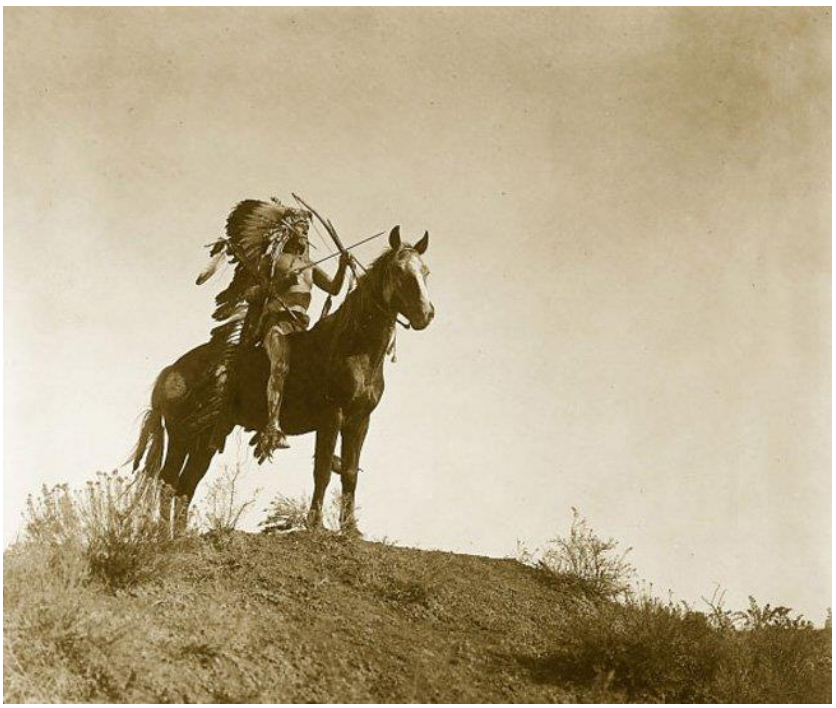
1. Who were the original settlers of the land that you are from?
2. Was the land they inhabited later invaded by any other group(s) of people? Who?
3. When was the last war fought in your country over territorial rights?
4. Who ultimately won possession of the land?
5. From which group of people did your country get its language and culture?
6. Were there any other races or ethnic groups that significantly influenced your country's customs and culture?

Next, in small groups discuss the following questions.
The United States was founded on the precept that "all men are created equal" (as stated in the Declaration of Independence).

We hold these truths to be self-evident: that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their creator with certain unalienable rights, that among these are life, liberty, and

The pursuit of happiness.

- Do you believe all men (and women) are treated equally in The United States? Explain.
- Do you believe all people are treated equally in your country? Explain.
- Do you believe a majority of people from your country are prejudiced against any other race or ethnic group? Explain.
- Is discrimination against any other ethnic group or race common in your country? Explain.



GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. LISTENING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Listen to a short history of a bloody period in the American past. Consider these questions as you listen to the historical account. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. Who inhabited the American continent when the first European immigrants arrived?
2. How did the settlers feel about these people?
3. The battles on the American frontier during the early 1800s were fought mostly between which two groups?
4. What were they fighting over?
5. What did the American government try to do with the Native Americans?
6. Was this conflict ever resolved? How? Who won?

B. IDENTIFY THE IDIOMS

Next, read the historical account to which you have just listened. Throughout this account you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

___ Wipe out
___ Save face
___ Uphill battle
___ Stop something in its tracks
___ Miss the boat
___ Take it out on someone
___ Sitting duck
___ Too close for comfort
___ Slip through one´s fingers
___ Not have a prayer
___ Bite off more than one can chew
___ Bring to one´s knees

AN UPHILL BATTLE

In the early 1800s, Americans began creating the legends of the Wild West by exploring the world that lay beyond their established settlements in the eastern United States. Wagon trains, cowboys herding cattle across wide-open ranges, the Gold Rush, and fiercely independent settlers pushing the frontiers of civilization are all images born of that time of exploration and adventure. The best-know legends of the Wild West, however, sprang from the tales of the cavalry and the Indians, who throughout the nineteenth century were engaged in a war for life and land that ultimately ended in tragedy. In one of the most ill-fated periods of American history, the once proud and powerful Indian nations were almost completely wiped out, betrayed by a government that stole their land in Exchange for empty promises.

The early American immigrants were offered cheap and abundant land on the frontier as long as they were willing to settle it. Not wanting to miss the boat, thousands rushed to take advantage of the government´s generosity, indifferent to the fact that they were invading Indian territory. Soon, however, they complained that the Indians were too close for comfort. The government tried to remove the tribes by offering them land further west, and while some Indians agreed to move to new land, many resisted the relocation efforts. Those Indians who stayed were sitting ducks; hostility toward them spread quickly throughout the new settlements, and most were killed.

Although a few brave Indian leaders tried desperately to stop the settlers' westward progression in its tracks, fighting back courageously when their territory was invaded, it was an uphill battle, and one that was doomed to failure. Even the few pockets of Indian resistance that somehow slipped through the militia's fingers were at last captured and either killed or forced to move.

More than 70,000 Indians of various tribes finally surrendered to government pressure to leave their homelands and resettle beyond the Mississippi River on the Great Plains, where they were promised sanctuary

"as long as trees grow and Waters run". The Indians endured so much suffering on that journey that the Cherokee called it the "trail of tears".

However, the settlers backed by the U.S. Cavalry continued to encroach upon Indian land, for a brief period out from the long history of Indian defeat, George Armstrong Custer, with a regiment of 655 men, attacked a Sioux village, resulting in what is commonly called Custer's Last Stand.

The officer and his men, tired of the constant skirmishers with their enemies, determined to bring the Indians to their knees. They realized too late, however, that they had bitten off more than could chew.

The village turned out to be a camp of 2,500 to 4,000 Sioux and Cheyenne warriors, who completely overwhelmed and destroyed the regiment. Such battles were rare, though. The White settlers' hatred grew and they continued to take it out on innocent tribal women on children. More and more Indians were Killed or sent to live on desolate reservations apart from the settlers. It was not long before the native population, once strong, was decimated.

The final event in the war between the government and the Indians was not a battle; it was a massacre. On December 29, 1890, approximately 300 unarmed Sioux men, women, and children were peacefully gathered at Wounded knee Creek after their leader, Sitting Bull, was killed.

The Indians didn't have a prayer when they were attacked by the heavily armed U.S. Cavalry. While trying to surrender, they were all brutally murdered.

In a final effort to save face, the U.S. government, since 1970, has given back more than 4,5 million acres of Indians land that was wrongfully taken by the White settlers, and it has paid more than $1 billion for land that cannot be returned.

The Indians that survive from this bloody period of history are unmoved. Their culture and heritage are nearly extinct. "Now", they say "there is nothing left. But we must go on. Like the buffalo, we must turn and face the Wind".

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following sentences. Pay attention to how the idiom is used, and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding historical account. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line. The first one is done for you.

1. As a result of the vaccine developed by Dr. Jonas Salk. Polio was almost completely **wiped out** by the mid-1950s.

Eliminate

2. If we don't get in line now to buy tickets to the concert, we'll **miss the boat**.

_____

3. If I had missed one more question on the exam, I wouldn't have passed. That's **too close for comfort**.

_____

4. Victor was a **sitting duck**. He didn't realize he was playing against a world Champion until he had already lost more than $100.

_____

5. The killer bees are migrating steadily northward toward California, but the Department of Agriculture has guaranteed that it will **stop them in their tracks** before they get there.

_____

6. Stewart is terrified of the water. Teaching him to swim is an **uphill battle**.

_____

7. Although the police carefully searched the area, the thieves somehow **slipped through their fingers** once again.

_____

8. The earthquake destroyed all transportation and communication systems, **bringing the city to its knees.**

_____

9. Sandy is only a first-year lawyer, but she is representing a multimillion-dollar Corporation. I hope she didn't **bite off more than she can chew**.

_____

10. I know you're angry at your bass, but don't **take it out on me**!

_____

11. The tennis match was between unranked Katy Walker and the reigning champion. Monica Seles. Walker **didn't have a prayer**.

_____

12. Senator Robinson was caught accepting a bribe from a large company. He tried to **save face** by claiming the Money was just a loan.

_____

PRACTICING THE IDIOMS

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Decide if the sentence that corresponds to each is true or false. Circle T if it is true and F if it is false.

1. T/F They need more information about the library fire.
2. T/F The last contestant probably won the prize.
3. T/F Some people felt they were in danger from the falling meteor.
4. T/F Those who were on the front lines could more easily escape harm.
5. T/F The researchers believe that AIDS will become more prevalent with the passage of time.
6. T/F The United States will probably soon win many soccer games again the best teams from other countries.
7. T/F The scientist nearly caught the monster, but it mysteriously escaped.
8. T/F An alternate source of fuel and energy would be readily available to developed countries.
9. T/F The entire symphony is too much for Sonya to learn in one month.
10. T/F It was probably his secretary's fault that hank lost the account.
11. T/F The combined United Nations army could most likely win any war.
12. T/F The wrestler tried to recover his dignity by making excuses for his loss.

E. RETELLING THE STORY-OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the historical account again. The sentences below refer to statements in that account. On the lines below, restate the sentences, using the appropriate idiom. The first one is done for you.

1. During one of the most shameful periods of American history, the American Indians were nearly completely destroyed.
During a tragic period of history, the American Indians were almost wiped out.

2. The government offered to give the immigrants free land, and many hurried to accept the offer because they didn't want to lose their chance.

_____

3. After moving onto Indian land, the settlers said that the Indians lived dangerously near.

_____

4. The Indians who did not immediately agree to move off their land were in a very vulnerable and unguarded position.

_____

5. A few Indians tried to stop the settlers from moving any further West, but it was very difficult task.

_____

6. The natives tried to fight back against the settlers, but it was nearly impossible to gain an advantage.

_____

7. The small number of Indians who escaped the army's attempts to face them to move was ultimately caught.

_____

8. Custer wanted to effectively weaken the power of the Indians.

_____

9. The officer and his small army realized that they had tried to do much more than they were capable of when they attacked the Sioux village.

_____

10. The settlers continued to vent their anger and frustration toward the Indians by attacking and killing their women and children.

_____

11. The unarmed Indians at Wounded Knee didn't have any chance of survival against the armed cavalry.

_____

12. Many years later, the American government tried to repair its damaged reputation by giving back Indian land and paying money for land that could not be returned.

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

The health Department is about to issue a warning to the residents of Rocky Bluffs County to notify them a rare, dangerous, and highly contagious virus has been identified in at least four victims and may be spreading.
Health officials are also going to send out the following memo to all doctors and medical personnel in the area. Fill in the blanks with the idioms listed below.

Uphill battle	**too close for comfort**
Wipe out	**sitting ducks**
Slip through our fingers	**doesn't have a prayer**
Brought the community to its knees	**stop the disease in its tracks**
Take it out on	**save face**
Bitten off more than they can chew	**miss the boat**

ALERT!!! This virus could potentially_____ the entire community, so you must diagnose and treat your patients very carefully. Be sure you are

aware of all signs and symptoms the virus may display, or you may_____ and suddenly find it is too late to help your patients. In that case, your reputation may also be in danger, and you will not be able to_____ by claiming you were not informed.

Remember that early intervention is essential; if the disease goes untreated for longer than forty-eight hours, the patient probably_____. Also keep in mind that children and old or infirm people are particularly vulnerable; they are_____, so they should Always be given first priority.

Although the only cases so far have been reported outside the city, that is still _____for most of the county's residents. The virus could spread in any direction, so make sure you stay informed of all cases at your local hospital. At this point in time, we do not know how the disease spreads, so remind your patients that it won't do them any good to _____ friends or Family members who have the disease.

Researchers are working day and night to contain the virus quickly, but as you know, there have been similar outbreaks in the past that have become epidemics, and have_____.

It is possible that in spite of their dedicated efforts to solve this medical mystery, the researchers may have_____.

However, there is no cause for alarm yet. Although it may be an _____, the Health Department is determined to_____.

A health official's final statement regarding this disease was, "this bug id going to get caught. We will not allow to_____".

II - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

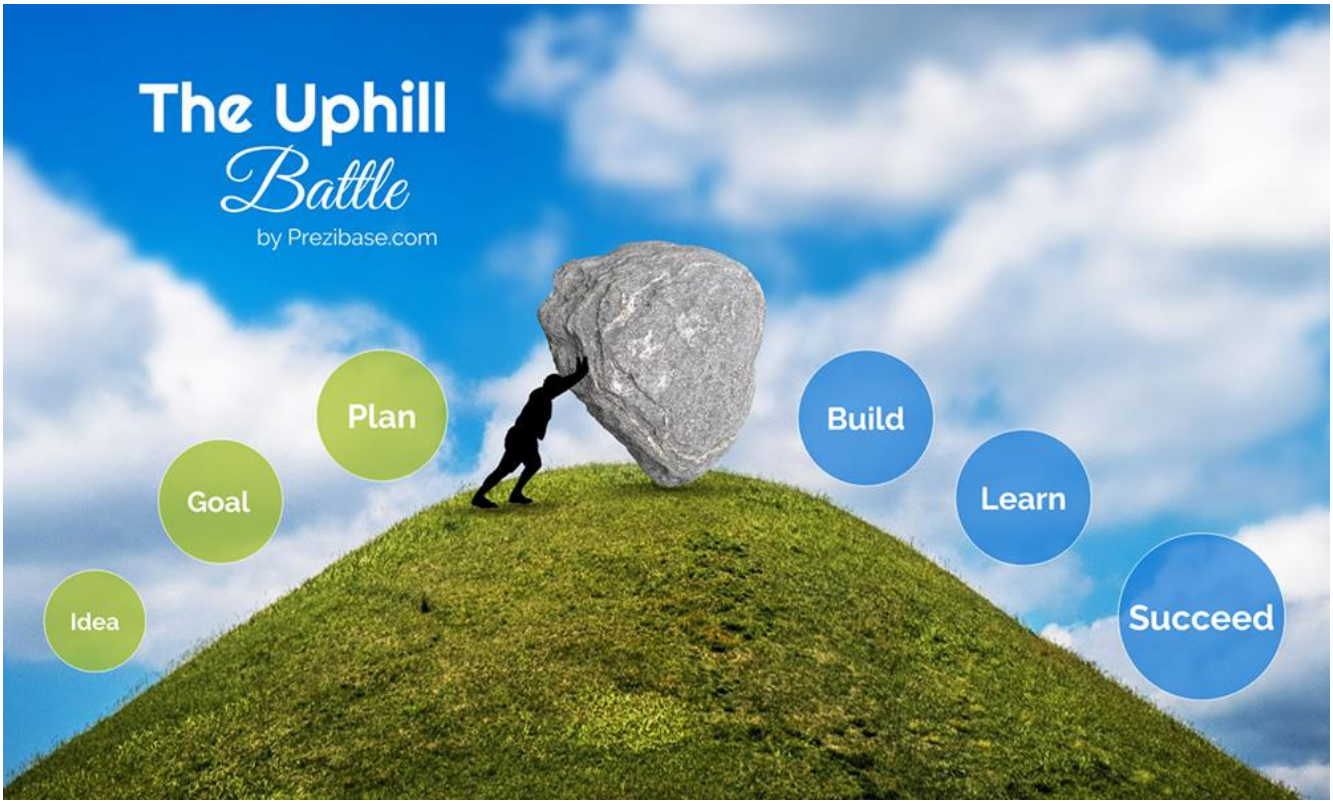
INTERPRETING THE ADS

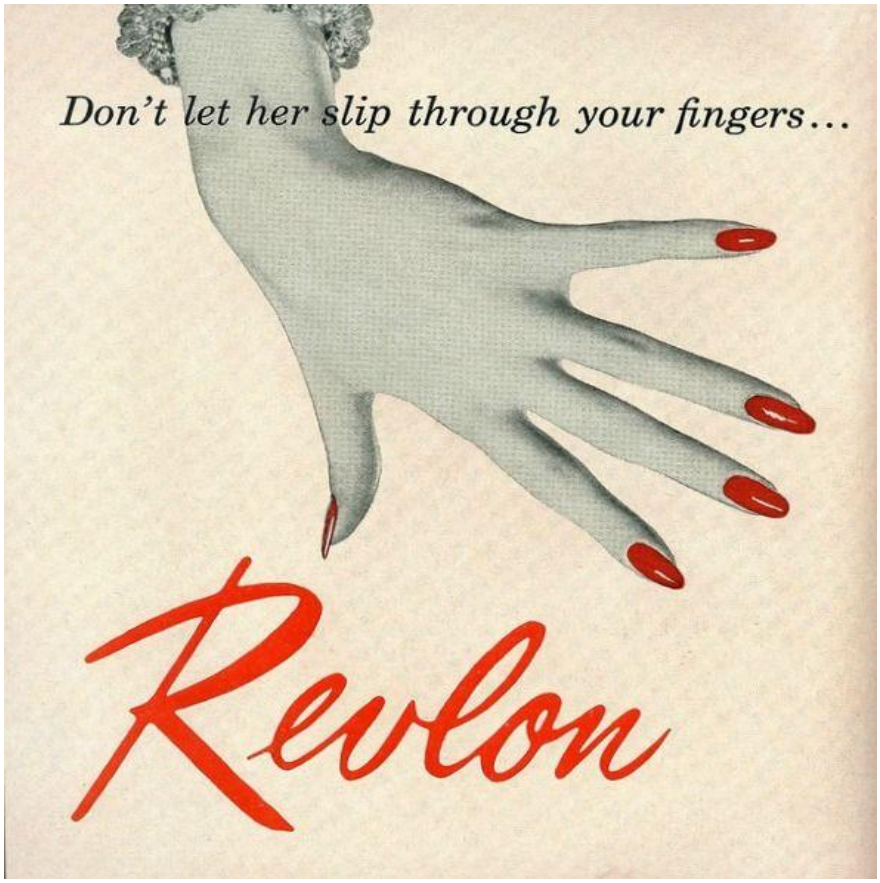
Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.

Save Face.
The Shore Center For
Plastic & Reconstructive Surgery
SHORE
CENTER FOR PLASTIC & RECONSTRUCTIVE SURGERY

WIPE-OUT
2 OR MORE ATTACKERS AT ONCE...
WITH JOE WEIDER'S DEADLY SELF-DEFENSE SYSTEM!

ARK
ENCOUNTER
DON'T MISS
THE BOAT!


The Uphill
Battle
by Prezibase.com
Idea
Goal
Plan
Build
Learn
Succeed



THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete statements one through four based on that ad.

1. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
2. It is important to many Americans to…
3. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
4. This ad would / wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because …
5. The ad that I liked the best is …
6. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS

USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech.

You have been asked to speak to the legislature to convince them to enact tougher laws against people who drive their cars when they're drunk. Drunk drivers cause over half of the traffic accidents in The United States. Thousands of people are seriously injured or killed as a result of people who drink and drive. You don't believe that current laws aimed at drunk drivers are strict enough, and you would like to propose harsher and more severe punishment for those who are caught.

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

Participate in the following discussion, using the idioms from this chapter.
International terrorism has become an increasingly serious problem. There is nowhere in the world where one can feel safe from the threat of violence by terrorists. Even in The United States, where most people have been somewhat insulated from terrorism, the bombing of the World Trade Center in New York City in 1993 proved that no country or its people is immune. Talk about this problem and what can be done about it with the other members of your group. Discuss the following points:

- Where do terrorist acts occur?
- Whom should we blame for terrorism?

- Is retaliatory action against a country that sponsors terrorism a legitimate response?
- What should be done with terrorists if they are caught?
- Should governments ever give in to terrorist demands?

C. DEBATE: NUCLEAR WEAPONS

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following question: Are nuclear weapons effective in maintaining world Peace, or is total disarmament of nuclear weapons our only guarantee of safety? Before you begin, jot down the arguments supporting you position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

Nuclear weapons have been a subject of controversy since 1945, when the first atomic bomb was detonated. Since that time, many developing nations have acquired the technology and materials necessary to manufacture nuclear weapons. The arms race is no longer between The United States and the former Soviet Union: now almost everyone has joined the race, and many people believe that the potential for world destruction is greater than ever before. Is total disarmament the answer? Or do you believe in maintaining a "balance of power"? Do nuclear weapons truly serve as a deterrent to hostile aggression? Is there any real way to "police" other countries in their attempts to manufacture nuclear weapons?

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (animal rights activist, scientist)

ANIMAL RIGHTS ACTIVIST: Hundreds of thousands of defenseless animals are killed each year in unnecessary and cruel experiments. You believe that many of these animals are exploited by unethical researchers who don't care about the suffering the animals endure. Often they are used to test cosmetics or other types of products that contribute nothing to the quality of human life. You think such experimentation should be stopped! Express your opinions.

SCIENTIST: Many people's lives have been saved by the knowledge that has come out of experimentation on animals. If new products, medicines, or surgical procedures were not first tested on animals, we could never be sure they are safe to use on humans. You and other scientists who experiment with animals are only trying to benefit humankind! Explain your stand on this issue.

2. (representative from an Indian tribe, government official)

INDIAN REPRESENTATIVE: Ever since the White settlers came, your people have always been treated very poorly. Now most of the Indians that are left live in poverty on reservations. Their housing, education, and medical care are all inferior to what other Americans have. You believe the government should help your people more.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL: You believe the American government has compensated the Indians very fairly for the injustices of the past. Now you think it is their responsibility to help themselves, rather than relying on government assistance. Tell the tribal representative that the Indians should no longer blame the government for their quality of life

USING THE INDIOMS IN WRITING

A. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

The story below is unfinished. How does it end? Use your imagination and finish it, either by yourself or with a partner, using many of the idioms from this chapter.

At nine o'clock on a dark, moonless night, Roger thought saw a large black shadow pass over his window. Thinking little of it, a few minutes later he went outside to walk his dog. The night seemed quiet and peaceful, but as they strolled along the dog appeared to tense up, his ears and tail pointing straight back and quivering nervously. Roger stopped and looked around him. "What's wrong, buddy"? He whispered to his dog. Suddenly a loud humming noise broke the calm. All around them appeared strange little creatures with heads that glowed like spooky lanterns, and Roger noticed a huge metallic sphere hovering several feet off the ground in front of him. Space aliens! The glowing creatures were moving closer and closer. Roger looked around and wondered how they would get away. At once he decided to....

B. ADVERTISING WITH IDIOMS

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one or more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience-the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present it to the class. Do you think this ad would appeal to the other members of your class?

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6

EFFORT

IDIOMS

- PUT ONE'S BEST FOOT FORWARD
- MAKE A SPLASH
- HAVE AN EDGE
- GET A LEG UP ON SOMEONE
- BEND OVER BACKWARDS
- STICK ONE'S NECK OUT
- GO TO GREAT LENGTHS
- GO TO THE ENDS OF THE EARTH
- ON THE GO
- TAKE THE LINE
- HAVE A GOOD HEAD ON ONE'S SHOULDERS
- LET SOMEONE DOWN
- TOE THE LINE

UNDERSTANDING THE IDIOMS

BEND OVER BACKWARDS

To make an extreme effort. You would bend over backwards for someone; don't try to insert anything between over and backwards.

Example: That waitress is bending over backwards for those people but they are still not satisfied.

GET A LEG UP ON SOMEONE

Get an advantage over someone.

Example: Steve stayed home and practiced while I went out dancing, so he got a leg up on me in the competition.

GO TO GREAT LENGTHS

To try very, very hard.

Example: I would go to great lengths to get this contract, but I won't do anything illegal.

GO TO THE ENDS OF THE EARTH

To do anything and everything possible.

This idiom is often used to illustrate one's dedication or devotion to someone.

Example: Michael is so deeply in love with Jane that he would go to the ends of the earth for her.

HAVE A GOOD HEAD ON ONE'S SHOULDERS

To be intelligent and sensible.

Example: Since Dave came into the department, we've done things a lot more sensibly. He's got a good head on his shoulders.

HAVE AN EDGE (OR **HAVE THE EDGE)**

To have an advantage over someone or something.

This idiom can be used alone (i.e., between the two, I think Sue has the edge.)
Example: It's hard to tell which of the cars will win the race, but I think that blue Camaro has an edge.
It can also be followed by on.
Example: Sue has an edge on Marie.

LET SOMEONE DOWN
To disappoint someone.
Example: I expect you to be there on time. Don't let me down!

MAKE A SPLASH
To attract a lot of attention.
Example: The play opened in New York last week, and it really made a splash. Everyone is talking about it!

ON THE GO
Constantly busy. You cannot be on the go somewhere; don't try to follow go with a place.
Example: You'll have to schedule an appointment with Mr. Luther a week in advance. He's always on the go.

PUT ONE'S BEST FOOT FORWARD
To try one's best; to try to make a good impression.
Example: Cynthia was determined to impress her guests at the dinner party. She put her best foot forward.

STICK ONE'S NECK OUT
To take a risk.
Example: You really stuck your neck out to defend me against that mob. They could have killed you!

TAKE SOMETHING IN STRIDE
To accept a difficult situation and move on.
The word or phrase that replaces something may come after take or after in stride.
Example: He took in stride the death of his young wife, and kept working as she would have wanted him to.

TOE THE LINE
To do exactly what is expected; to follow orders.
Example: Your behavior is unacceptable. You're going to have to toe the line or suffer the consequences.

I - LEARNING THE IDIOMS

WARMING UP

Complete the following activities in small groups of three to five students. Compare answers and discuss with your classmates.

1. What characteristic is most important to success? Rank the following characteristic of a successful person from 1 (most important) to 4 (least important). Discuss your opinions with the other members of your group.

____ambition/determination ____intelligence
____creativity/talent ____luck

2. Write the names of famous people, past or present, who have excelled in the following areas. Then determine which of the qualities listed above made them stand out in their field.

	Name	Quality
Music		
Art		
Sports		
Religion		
Politics		
Film		
Literature		
Business		
Science		

3. Discuss the following situations with the other members of your group:

a. There are five other people applying for job that you really want. What are you going to say or do in your job interview to distinguish yourself from the others?

b. You are one of three contestants on TV game show. A very attractive person of the opposite sex in behind a screen (unable to see you) asking questions to determine which of you three he/she would like to go out with on a date. How are you going the person to choose you?

c. You are looking for someone to fill a highly visible and important position. What qualities would you expect the best applicant to demonstrate? What questions would you ask to find out which person is for the job?

GETTING TO KNOW THE IDIOMS

A. READING FOR UNDERSTANDING

Read to the following multiple-choice quiz, which examines what you would do in several different business situations. Consider these questions as you listen to the quiz. Afterward, discuss the answers with your classmates in pairs or small groups.

1. Have you ever gotten sick when you had an important job to do?
2. Which do you think is harder: to supervise difficult employees or to have a difficult boss? What challenge does the mail-order business supervisor face?
3. What would you do if a less-qualified co-worker were promoted to a position that you wanted? Has that ever happened to you?
4. What is the best way to make the right impression in a business setting?
5. If an assignment at school or at work seems overwhelming, do you normally work harder to get it done, quit, or get someone to help you?

B. IDENTIFYING THE IDIOMS

Next, read the multiple-choice quiz to which you have just read. Throughout this quiz you will find the idioms listed below. Underline the idioms, and number them on the list in the order in which you find them. Can you tell what they mean by how they are used?

PUT ONE'S BEST FOOT FORWARD
TOE THE LINE
LET SOMEONE DOWN
ON THE GO

TAKE SOMETHING IN STRIDE
MAKE A SPLASH
HAVE A GOOD HEAD ON ONE'S SHOULDERS
STICK ONE'S NECK OUT
HAVE AN EDGE
BEND OVER BACKWARDS
GO TO GREAT LENGTHS
GO TO THE ENDS OF THE EARTH
GET A LEG UP ON SOMEONE

DO YOU ALWAYS PUT YOUR BEST FOOT FORWARD?

Do you have an edge in the workplace? Examine the following situations, and decide which response most closely fits what you would do.

1. You have a very important presentation to make to the board of directors of your company-one that could really advance your career. This morning, however, you woke up with a fever and a bad sore throat. You feel terrible! You should…

a. Put your best foot forward. Go to work anyway, and do your best in spite of how you feel.
b. Call the president and tell him that you're sorry to let him down, but you won't be in because you're sick.
c. Have your secretary buy donuts and coffee for the board of directors and tell them that it´s better than what you had planned anyway.

2. You supervise a number of employees at a mail-order business. Most of them are responsible and efficient, but one customer ordered a large man's shirt and the employee sent him a woman's bikini instead. You have tried talking to her, but she doesn't pay much attention to your instructions. You should …

a. Tell her that she must toe the line or lose her job. If she doesn't do what you tell her, she will be fired.
b. Simply accept the fact that some people don't have a good head on their shoulders. Maybe she just needs simpler assignments.
c. Call the customer, and tell him the bikini was a bonus gift for being the one-millionth customer.

3. You have gone to great lengths in your job in hopes of being promoted to manager; you come in early, late, and have received a lot of your exceptional work. Nevertheless, another employee (whom you consider to be less qualified) was given the position instead. You should …

a. Take it in stride. Although it's disappointing, you will have other chances to get ahead.
b. Sincerely congratulate the new manager on getting a leg up on you.
c. Leave work early one day and flatten all the tires on the new manager's car.

4. You work for an advertising agency that is trying to get the account of a huge fast-food chain. This could mean millions of dollars for the agency; it's the charge of trying to convince the company to hire your agency. You should …
a. Stick your neck out by promising them that if food sales don't go up during the six months after they hire you, they won't have to pay.
b. Make a splash by coming to your meeting dressed like a hamburger.
c. Tell the company that you are willing to represent them only if they will change their menu; you are a vegetarian.

5. You have been working on an assignment for several weeks and the deadline for completion of your Project is fast approaching. You have been staying at your office until almost ten o'clock every night, working weekends, and even taking work home to complete late at night. You are exhausted! You should …

a. Bend over backwards to meet the deadline. When it's all over you can take a vacation.
b. Tell your boss that you've been on the go constantly for weeks and you need some help to finish the Project.
c. Sweetly inform your boss that despite his perception that you would go to the ends of the Earth for the company, you need your sleep more. Then go home.

Which letter did you choose most often? If you picked:
A - You definitely have an edge in the workplace. You will go to great lengths to achieve success in your career.
B - Most often, you should probably work in a job that does not require a high level of responsibility.
C - Perhaps you should consider psychological counseling before applying for your next job.

C. GETTING THE MEANING

Notice the highlighted phrase in each of the following sentences. Pay attention to how the idiom is used, and try to guess its meaning. You may also refer to the preceding quiz. Write the meaning of the idiom on the line. The first one is done for you.

1. Scott and Mike are evenly matched in track events, but in weight lifting, Mike definitely **has an edge**.
Has an advantage
2. When Mary met Doug's parents for the first time, she **put her best foot forward**.
_____
3. Sue's husband promised her he would stop drinking, but once again he **let her down** and got drunk.
_____

4. The rules here are very strict, so if you don't think you can **toe the line**, it would be better for you to leave now.

_____

5. Even though Joelle didn't go to college, she **has a good head on her shoulders**. You ought to listen to her.

_____

6. I'm proud of how Jeff reacted to the newspaper's review of his book. Although it was mostly negative, he just **took it in stride**.

_____

7. Barbara **got a leg up** on the other reporters by getting to the bank just after it had been robbed. She was the first one to talk to the bank manager and the police who were investigating the crime.

_____

8. Although he knew the baseball player needed a lot of work, the coach **stuck his neck out** for him and got a chance to play with the team.

_____

9. Nicky really **made a splash** at the town meeting. A week later everyone is still talking about how great her speech was.

_____

10. That poor woman! She **bends over backwards** to make her husband happy, but he still pays more attention to other women than he does to her.

_____

11. I don't know when you even have time to eat. You are Always **on the go**! Don't you ever slow down?

_____

12. Marla, believe me! I would **go to the ends of the earth** for you! What must I do to prove my everlasting love?

_____

13. Detective Barner is determined to catch the guy that killed that little boy. He will **go to great lengths** to find out who is responsible.

_____

PRACTICING THE IDIOMS

D. CHOOSING THE BEST ANSWER

Listen carefully to your teacher. Read the choices listed below for each statement you hear. Select the sentence that best relates to the original statement, and circle the corresponding letter.

1-
a. Senator Curtis will probably win.
b. Senator Curtis will have to work harder to win.

2-
a. I decided to run away from my awful job.
b. I resolved to try again and do a better job.

3-
a. Everyone expected Shelly to act differently.
b. Shelly gave us a great surprise.

4-
a. Bob wants to find another job.
b. Bob will be fired unless he does what Phyllis says.

5-
a. Jim is quite good-looking.
b. Jim is sensible and intelligent.

6-
a. Joey tried to get away as soon as possible.
b. Joey was not overly preoccupied with the earthquake.

7-
a. James lost the advantage because he was too late.
b. Billy can't go until next time.

8-
a. She risks losing Calvin by forcing him to decide.
b. It took her nine years to decide to marry Calvin.

9-
a. It is probably a swimming party.
b. You are liked to attract a lot of attention.

10-
a. The extra effort didn't affect the outcome.
b. It wasn't possible to finish on time.

11-

a. Ellen had to go somewhere at six in the morning.
b. Ellen has had a very busy day.

12-

a. The professor travels all over the world to find alien beings.
b. The professor will do anything to prove that he is correct.

RETELLING THE STORY - OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

Read the multiple-choice quiz again. The sentence below refers statements in that quiz. On the lines below, restate the sentences, using the appropriate idiom in each one. The first one is done for you.

1. Do you have an advantage over other workers at your job?
Do you have an edge on the people you work with?
2. If you are sick on the day of an important presentation, you should try hard to do your best anyway.

_____

3. Maybe you should call and tell the president you are sorry to disappoint him but you're sick.

_____

4. When an employee doesn't pay attention or follow orders, you should tell her that if she doesn't do what is expected, you will fire her.

_____

5. Some people are simply not very sensible.

_____

6. If someone is promoted to a position you were hoping to fill, you should accept it and move on.

_____

7. Should you tell the other person that you are pleased that he/she got the advantage over you?

_____

8. If your ad agency is trying to lure a fast-food restaurant chain to be represented by you, you should take a risk and offer them free services if their sales do not improve.

_____

9. Some people might attract attention by doing something outrageous, like dressing up as a hamburger for a meeting with representatives of a fast-food company.

_____

10. If you are exhausted from overwork, you should do everything you can to finish the Project, and then you can relax.

_____

11. Another option is to tell your boss that you have been busy and working constantly, and you need help.

_____

12. Your boss may believe that you would do anything for some sleep.

_____

13. If you chose the letter a more than any other, it shows that you are willing to make a great effort to succeed in your job.

_____

F. PUTTING THE IDIOMS INTO PRACTICE

You have just enrolled at Kingston University, a prestigious private university with very high standards. Your parents have written you the following letter of advice to help you during your first year. Substitute one of the idioms listed below for each of the numbered phrases. Remember to change the idioms as needed to fit the sentences.

Put one's best foot forward
Take something in stride
Bend over backwards
Get a leg up on someone

On the go
Stick one's neck out
Go to the ends of the Earth
Let someone down
Make a splash with
Have an edge
Toe the line
Have a good head on one's shoulders
Go to great lengths

Dear_____,

We're so proud that you have been accepted to Kingston. I'm sure you know what a great opportunity it is to attend one of the world's finest and most prestigious universities. You_____ and we are confident that you will be successful in your academic pursuits. However, we would like to offer you some advice before you begin the school year. We hope you will follow our counsel; we believe it will help you _____ the other students there.

You have already showed us that you are willing to _____ to do well. That will be even more necessary in college, where you are competing against hundreds of intelligent students like yourself. You must always _____ in order to distinguish yourself from all the others. In fact, it probably wouldn't hurt to do something extraordinary to _____ your professor (as long as it doesn't cause you to receive any negative attention).

Be sure to always _____ while you are at the university—both in and out of class. You won't get anywhere if you can't follow the rules.

You may occasionally be assigned a professor who seems to be overly demanding. In such cases, you should _____ to please him or her.

You might even _____ and after to do extra work—whatever it takes to let your professor know that you would _____ to get a good grade. And if after all that you still get a lower mark than you expected _____.

If you do all these things, when you graduate you will _____ in the job Market. Please don't _____. We know that you are always _____, but we hope you will write every now and then to let us know how you're doing. We are anxious to hear about your life at Kingston.

Love always,
Mom and Dad

III - FINDING THE IDIOMS IN ADS

INTERPRETING THE ADS

Look at the following advertisements. First, determine what is being advertised and what idiom is featured in the ad. Review the meaning of the idiom. Then answer the questions corresponding to each ad.

HOW TO PUT YOUR BEST FOOT FORWARD

PLANTAR FASCIITIS

FULLER Chiropractic & Wellness

FREE Make A Splash

A Water Safety Event for the Whole Family!
Hosted by Texas Children's Hospital West Campus and KATY Aquatics

KATY Aquatics

Saturday, May 11, 2019
Cinco Ranch High School Natatorium
(23440 Cinco Ranch Blvd., Katy, TX)
10am – 12:30pm

FREE Car Seat Safety Check from 9am - 12:30pm at Make A Splash! The Safe Kids Greater Houston Coalition will have certified technicians on location to help properly install and secure your child's car seat. Appointments are recommended, but not required. Call 832-824-3488 to schedule today!

Texas Children's Hospital | West Campus

USA Swimming Foundation MAKE A SPLASH

SAFE KIDS GREATER HOUSTON

www.katyaquatics.org / Email: learntoswim@katyaquatics.org / Office: 281-391-7200

Hargrove Design Group, 04.19

THINKING ABOUT THE ADS

Review the ads from this chapter. Based on the messages contained in the ads, choose the one that you think best illustrates American cultural values. Complete statements one through four based on that ad.

3. This ad would appeal to an American audience because ...
4. It is important to many Americans to…
5. Other examples in American life that show how Americans feel about this issue or value are…
6. This ad would / wouldn't appeal to an audience from my country because …
7. The ad that I liked the best is …
8. The ad that made the best use of an idiom is … because …

III - USING THE IDIOMS

USING THE IDIOM IN SPEECH

A. ONE-MINUTE SPEECH

Write a brief outline before presenting your one-minute speech to your classmates. Be sure to use the idioms from this chapter in your speech.

You are a drama coach for several young actors and actresses (played by the other members of your group). They are about to audition for their first big part in a movie. What should they do to get the part? What advice can you give them to increase their chances of the director choosing them? Give them a "pep talk" to encourage and motivate them to do their best.

B. GROUP DISCUSSION

Participate in the following discussion, using the idioms from this chapter.

You are all members of special public relations groups that have been hired to help out a candidate for vice president of The United States. The candidate, Bob Bore, is highly respected in political circles, but the public perceives him as being too stiff and lacking good personal communication skills. You job is to help him change the image so that the public will see him as warm, friendly, and concerned.

Discuss the following:

- The candidate is always running on a very tight schedule. Should he slow down and take more time to talk to individuals?
- Mr. Bore needs to make a good impression on each new group the meets: maybe he should take more risks and do extraordinary things to get people's attention.
- The American public needs to see his Strong points: he is highly intelligent and will do what is required to get things done.

- People should feel that he would do absolutely anything for his country and that he won't disappoint them.
- How can Mr. Bore gain an advantage over his opponent?

C. DEBATE: GRADING ON A CURVE

Read the situation and choose to defend either side of the following question: Is the system of grading on a curve fair to all students? Before you begin, job down the arguments supporting your position. Remember to use as many of the idioms from this chapter as you can.

Many students in schools around The United States are doomed to failure because of the time-honored system of grades on a curve. In classes where teachers use this traditional method of determining the grades in a class, a certain number of students will fail. On most exams, the scores typically fall into a bell curve pattern: There are a few outstanding scores are, if the teacher grades on a curve, they fail because they are below the average. It can be argued, of course, that anyone can avoid being below average, and that the system does an excellent job of eliminating those who probably shouldn't be there in the first place. On the other hand, because the curve shifts a little to the right or to the left with different groups of students, the definition of average changes as well. What was a high mark in one class may be a low mark in another, and vice versa. Is this system fair?

D. ROLE PLAYS

Imagine yourself in one of the situations described below. Act it out with another member of your class, using as many idioms from this chapter as you can in your conversation. You and your partner may want to write a brief script of the role play before acting it out.

1. (hypnotist, client)

HYPNOTIST: Your client is a heavy smoker. He/she has tried to quit on several occasions, but nothing has worked so far. Tell your client that you can guarantee that your treatment Works: your client will stop if he/she really wants to. Convince your client that it is worth the effort to quit.

CLIENT: You really want to stop smoking, and you would do just about anything to succeed this time. Tell the hypnotist that you will do whatever is required of you.

2. (unemployed worker, job counselor)

WORKER: You have been out of work for about a year, and during that time you have lost all confidence in your ability to get a job. Although you are intelligent, you don't know how to make the right impression on a prospective employer.

COUNSELOR: You need to instruct this worker on various techniques that would help him/her get a good job. Help this person understand what is required of a good employee, and what a prospective employer will look for.

E. WRITING WITH IDIOMS

Retell the story described below, using the idioms from this chapter.

Do you know the story of "The Tortoise and the Hare"? The tortoise (turtle) and the hare (rabbit) run a race, which the hare is naturally expected to win. However, after taking a huge lead, the overconfident hare stops to take a nap, and as he sleeps, the slow but persistent fable in which the characters of the story make an extraordinary effort to succeed?

F. ADVERTISING WITH IDIOMS

Make up an advertisement for any type of product not advertised in the ads in this chapter, using one more of the idioms you have just learned. Follow the steps listed below.

1. Choose a product or service that you would like to advertise.
2. Determine your audience – the people most likely to buy your product or service.
3. Determine what value(s) would appeal to that audience. How are you going to incorporate that value into your ad?
4. Make up a slogan, using one of the idioms from this chapter.
5. Decide what visual cues (pictures, etc.) will accompany the slogan.
6. Write the rest of the ad.
7. Present in to the class. Do you think ad would appeal to the other members of your class?